A KITCHEN LIBRARY FIELD GUIDE

5 Alive.

Five glasses a day, one small plate, and most of what a body needs.

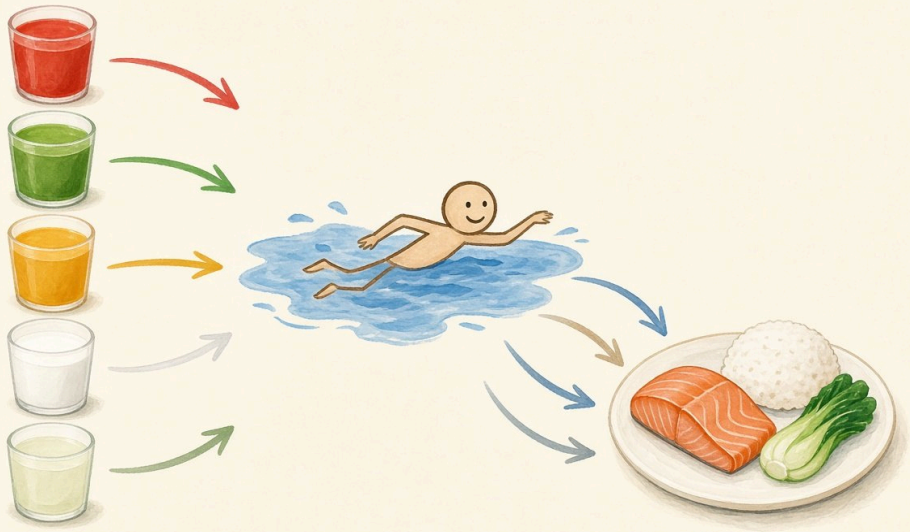


A small field guide for the house kitchen



A Word Before We Pour

The standard advice is to drink water and eat your vegetables, and it's good advice. But here's a house idea worth taking seriously. If you already eat meat and rice without thinking about it, protein and starch take care of themselves. What most people miss are the quieter things: potassium, vitamin C, calcium, B12, fiber. Five well-chosen drinks a day can cover a big share of that, and then a short list of plain foods, the kind you can buy in almost any country, can close the rest. It isn't magic, and it isn't for everyone. It costs sugar and calories, so it suits people who move a lot. This book shows you what the five cover, what they can't, and how to build a day around them. Pour one, baby.



SECTION 1 · THE FIVE

The Idea in One Page

- **Protein and starch look after themselves.** A meat-and-carb eater rarely runs short of either.
- **The gaps are elsewhere.** Typical shortfalls for people eating a modern diet include potassium, fiber, calcium, magnesium, vitamin D and omega-3 fats. *(Well established: these show up again and again in national diet surveys.)*
- **Drinks are easy to repeat.** A drink takes no cooking, travels well and tastes the same every day. Habits beat plans.
- **So:** let five drinks carry the vitamins and minerals, and let a small plate carry the rest.
- **The catch:** five drinks bring about 525 kcal and 62 g of fruit sugar, plus about 10 g of milk sugar *(juices from the labels, milk typical; see page 11)*. That's fine on a training day and too much on a lazy one.



Meet the Five

1. **A red veg-and-fruit juice with fiber** — for potassium, vitamin C, zinc and lycopene.
2. **A green veg-and-fruit juice with fiber** — for vitamin C, B6, some vitamin D, and probiotics.
3. **One sweet, natural fruit drink** — the house pick is a grape-mango blend. For pleasure, quick carbs, and a surprising amount of vitamins A and C.
4. **A glass of good whole milk** — organic in the house kitchen. For calcium, B12, protein and iodine. **Pinch hitter:** a bowl of plain or Greek yogurt (page 8).
5. **Coconut water** — the potassium heavyweight, and easy hydration after heat.

In the house kitchen these are Malee Power Plants Red and Green, Chabaa 100% Mango with Grape, Chabaa Coco 100% coconut water, and organic whole pasteurised milk. Anywhere else, see page 20.



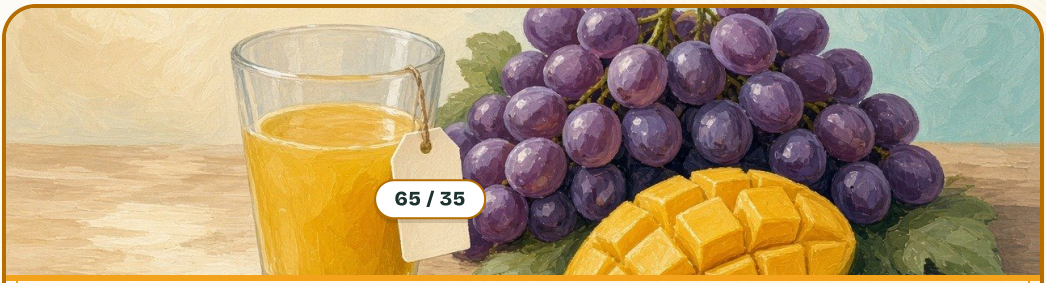
1 2 Drinks 1 & 2: The Power Plants

Two veg-and-fruit juices with fiber added back. Per 330 ml box (label):

	Red	Green
Energy	140 kcal	120 kcal
Carbs	33 g	28 g
— natural sugar	15 g	15 g
— fiber (added back)	8 g	8 g
— other carbs (label doesn't split)	10 g	5 g
Added sugar	0 g	0 g
Potassium	500 mg	320 mg
Vitamin C	100%	100%
Extras	zinc 70%, lycopene 4.45 mg	B6 35%, vitamin D 25%, probiotics
Price	฿38.8	฿38.8

Why both? Red is the potassium and zinc box. Green is the B6 and vitamin D box. Together they give 16 g of fiber, more than half of what most people actually eat in a day.

Honest note: the fiber is added back after juicing, so it helps your gut, but it isn't the same as eating the vegetables (see page 12).



3 Drink 3: The Sweet One

One drink a day is just for joy. In the house kitchen it's Chabaa 100% Mango with Grape Juice, ฿101.2 per 1 L box, so **฿20.2 per 200 ml glass**.

- **It's mostly grape.** The ingredients are grape juice 65% and mango juice 35%, both from concentrate. So it's really a grape-mango blend with a mango name on the box.
- **The surprise: real vitamins.** One 200 ml glass gives **50% of a day's vitamin C and 20% of a day's vitamin A** *(label, Thai RDI)*. That's more than I expected from the "fun" drink.
- **What it costs you:** 100 kcal and 24 g of sugar per glass, all from the fruit, with no added sugar (label). Carbs 25 g, potassium 140 mg, sodium 10 mg, no fat, no protein.
- **Pick one that says "100% juice."** "Nectar" and "drink" on the box usually mean sugar has been added.
- **Best time:** after a swim or a row, when your muscles want the sugar back.
- **First to go on a rest day.** It's the biggest single sugar hit of the five.
- **The hot-day swap: grape Royal-D.** On a hot, sweaty training day, like a swim or a row, a grape Royal-D sachet can fill this sweet slot instead. It's still a treat, about 90 kcal and 22 g of sugar *(house log; label figures pending)*, but with something useful in it: about 200 mg of sodium and a little potassium, which is what you've just sweated out. On those days the salts are a plus, not a minus. ฿6.5 a sachet *(house pantry)*. Two things to know: its sugar is **added sugar**, so on a swap day the day's added sugar goes from 0 to about 22 g. And **it's one or the other, never both** in the same day. Keep the mango-grape for cooler days and rest days. On a rest day, if you want a sweet one at all, make it the mango-grape: it brings vitamins A and C, and you don't need the salt.



4 Drink 4: Good Milk

The glass that carries the minerals juice can't. The house kitchen uses **organic whole milk**. Per 200 ml glass *(typical values for whole milk at about 3.3–3.5% fat, estimate; not a label)*:

- **About 125 kcal and 6.5 g of protein,** a real dose of complete protein.
- **Fat about 7 g, of which about 4 g saturated.**
- **Carbs about 10 g, all lactose.** No fruit sugar, no added sugar in plain milk.
- **Calcium about 230 mg,** close to a third of the Thai daily value.
- **Vitamin B12 about 0.9 µg,** close to half a day's need.
- **Potassium about 270 mg.**
- **Iodine:** often a good amount, but it varies by country, farm and season.
- **Vitamin D varies by brand.** Many Thai fresh milks, organic ones included, aren't fortified. Check the label; if it doesn't list vitamin D, count it as none.

Does organic matter? Organic milk has slightly more omega-3 fat, but the amount is tiny next to a piece of fish. Some studies find organic milk is lower in iodine. *(Reasonably well established; small differences either way.)* Buy organic because you like it, not because it fills a gap.

Price: the house kitchen pays ฿95.0 for 2 L of organic whole milk, so **฿9.5 per 200 ml glass** ***(house receipt)***. The cheapest of the five by a mile.

If milk bothers you: lactose-free milk keeps the same nutrients, or send in the pinch hitter on the next page.



The Pinch Hitter: Yogurt

Drink #4 has a stand-in. **A bowl of plain yogurt or Greek yogurt can take the milk's place**, because it does the same jobs: protein, calcium and B12. It also brings live cultures, and it has less lactose, because the cultures eat some of it and straining drains more away with the whey. *(Well established.)*

Per typical serving *(nutrition: typical values for whole-milk products, estimate, not labels; prices: house receipts, milk ฿95.0 per 2 L, premium Greek yogurt (Union Farmers) ฿399.0 per 2 kg tub)*:

	Organic whole milk, 200 ml	Plain whole-milk yogurt, 150 g	Greek yogurt (whole), 150 g
Energy	~125 kcal	~90 kcal	~145 kcal
Protein	~6.5 g	~5 g	~13.5 g
Lactose / milk sugar	~10 g	~7 g	~6 g
Calcium	~230 mg	~180 mg	~150 mg
Vitamin B12	~0.9 µg	~0.55 µg	~1.1 µg
Live cultures	no	yes	yes
Price in the house kitchen	฿9.5	not bought	฿29.9 (the house tub)

- **Greek yogurt doubles the protein,** but **its calcium is a bit lower**, because some calcium leaves with the whey when it's strained.
- **Pick milk** when you want it drinkable and fast: after the sauna, on the go, alongside a meal.
- **Pick a yogurt bowl** as breakfast after the swim, where it does the milk's job *and* starts the day's protein. Then supercharge it: the bonus chapter, **The Morning Bowl** (page 41), has 100 ways.
- **Read the tub:** plain and unsweetened. Flavoured yogurts can carry as much added sugar as a soft drink.
- **Swapping it in:** a Greek bowl instead of the milk adds about 20 kcal and 7 g of protein to the day, and drops about 4 g of lactose, before any mix-ins **(estimate)**. It costs ฿20.4 more than the glass of milk, before mix-ins.



5 Drink 5: Coconut Water

Nature's sports drink, or close to it. In the house kitchen it's Chabaa Coco 100% coconut water, ฿83.3 per 1 L box, so **฿16.7 per 200 ml glass**.

- **The big win: potassium.** One 200 ml glass has **560 mg, 16% of a day's need** (label). That's more than a whole Red box, in a smaller glass, for 40 kcal. Glass for glass, it's the potassium champion of the book.
- **Light on everything else:** 40 kcal, 9 g carbs, 8 g natural sugar, no fat, no protein (label).
- **Sodium 30 mg** (label). That's low, and sodium is the main thing you lose in sweat. After a long, hot session or the sauna, eat something salty alongside.
- **Best time:** after the sauna or a sweaty session. It rehydrates about as well as water, with potassium on top.
- **Read the box:** "100% coconut water" with one ingredient, like this one. Some brands add sugar.

SECTION 2 · WHAT THE FIVE COVER

The Grid

What each serving brings. ● = 15% or more of a day's need, ◐ = about 5–14%, ○ = less than that, ✓ = present but there's no daily value *(the kitchen's summary against the Thai daily values: label figures for the juices and coconut water, typical values for milk).*

Nutrient	1 Red	2 Green	3 Grape-mango	4 Milk	5 Coconut
Potassium	◐	◐	○	◐	●
Vitamin C	●	●	●	○	○
Vitamin A	○	○	●	◐	○
Fiber	●	●	○	○	○
Zinc	●	○	○	◐	○
Lycopene	✓	○	○	○	○
Vitamin B6	○	●	○	○	○
Vitamin D	○	●	○	varies	○
Calcium	○	○	○	●	○
Vitamin B12	○	○	○	●	○
Riboflavin (B2)	○	○	○	●	○
Iodine	○	○	○	◐ varies	○
Protein	○	○	○	◐	○
Probiotics	○	✓	○	○	○
Fluid	●	●	●	●	●

Potassium: about 1,790 mg a day from the five, around half the Thai daily value of 3,500 mg, before you've eaten a thing. Coconut water brings almost a third of it.

Pinch hitter: a yogurt bowl in the milk column scores about the same: Greek yogurt moves protein up to ●● and calcium stays ●● (a little lower), and it adds live cultures ✓ **(estimate)**.



The Numbers

All five, one serving each:

	kcal	Fruit sugar	Added sugar	Lactose	Fiber	Starch	Potassium
Red, 330 ml (label)	140	15 g	0 g	0 g	8 g	~0 g	500 mg
Green, 330 ml (label)	120	15 g	0 g	0 g	8 g	~0 g	320 mg
Grape-mango, 200 ml (label)	100	24 g	0 g	0 g	0 g	0 g	140 mg
Whole milk, 200 ml *(typical)*	~125	0 g	0 g	~10 g	0 g	0 g	~270 mg
Coconut water, 200 ml (label)	40	8 g	0 g	0 g	0 g	0 g	560 mg
Total	**~525**	**62 g**	**0 g**	**~10 g**	**16 g**	**~0 g**	**~1,790 mg**

The labels don't split every gram: Red and Green have 10 g and 5 g of carbs the label doesn't name, and the grape-mango and coconut water have 1 g each.

The honest part: the World Health Organization counts the sugar in fruit juice as "free sugar," the same category as added sugar, and suggests keeping free sugars under about 50 g a day on a normal diet. Five drinks puts you at 62 g, about 12 g over, and the grape-mango glass alone is 24 g of it. *(Well established guidance.)* Milk sugar doesn't count toward that limit.

What makes it OK: hard training burns through sugar fast. A swim plus a row and sauna can easily use several hundred kcal *(rough estimate)*, and the sugar goes to refilling your muscles instead of hanging around. On a rest day, cut back (page 15).



What Drinks Can't Do

Here's where the five fall short, and what fills each gap.

- **Omega-3 fats:** essentially none in the five. **Fix:** oily fish twice a week: salmon, mackerel or sardines. *(Well established.)*
- **Magnesium:** coconut water and milk give a little, nowhere near enough. **Fix:** leafy greens, beans, seeds, oats.
- **Whole fiber:** added-back fiber helps, but whole vegetables and beans bring more kinds of fiber, plus the chewing, the bulk and the plant compounds that juicing loses. *(Reasonably well established; how much the difference matters is less clear.)* **Fix:** a vegetable at every meal and beans most days.
- **Iron:** almost none in the drinks. **Fix:** red meat, chicken thighs, dark greens, beans.
- **Choline:** very little in the drinks. **Fix:** eggs, by far the easiest source, plus meat and fish.
- **Vitamin K:** none to speak of. **Fix:** leafy greens.
- **Protein beyond milk:** one glass gives about 6.5 g. **Fix:** a palm of meat or fish at each meal, or the Greek yogurt pinch hitter (page 8).
- **Chewing and fullness:** liquid calories don't fill you up like food. *(Reasonably well established.)* Don't let the drinks replace meals. They sit alongside them.



SECTION 3 · THE SMALL PLATE

The Small Plate

A short list, sold in almost every country, that closes the gaps on page 12. You don't need everything every day; aim to touch each group a few times a week.

- **Oily fish:** salmon, mackerel, sardines. Fresh, frozen or tinned. *(omega-3, vitamin D, protein)*
- **Chicken or pork:** thighs, mince, chops. *(protein, iron, zinc)*
- **Eggs, hidden:** stirred into congee as ribbons, mixed into fried rice, folded into fish cakes or croquettes. *(choline, B12)*
- **A staple starch:** rice, potatoes or oats. *(energy; oats bring magnesium)*
- **Leafy greens:** bok choy, spinach, kale, Chinese kale, whatever's local. *(magnesium, vitamin K, folate, whole fiber)*
- **Beans:** navy, black or kidney beans, or edamame. *(fiber, magnesium, iron)*
- **Seeds:** sunflower or pumpkin, a small handful. *(magnesium, vitamin E, zinc)*
- **Plain yogurt:** Greek-style if you can. *(protein, calcium, cultures)*
- **One whole fruit:** banana, mango, orange, an apple, whatever's in season. *(whole fiber, vitamin C)*

That's nine things. Most supermarkets in the world sell all nine. For ten choices in each of the three main groups, with scores, see The Other Half (page 26).



A Training Day

For a swim morning and an afternoon row and sauna. *(The kitchen's practical plan, not a prescription. Times assume an early bedtime.)*

- **On waking:** water before you go.
- **After the swim, breakfast: milk, or the pinch hitter**: a Greek yogurt Morning Bowl (pages 8 and 41) with a ★ post-swim combo. Or congee with an egg stirred in, with the milk alongside. Coffee here: the house double-shot Americano, split into two cups, or the coffee swap, a short hot flat white, which brings a splash of milk with it (page 19). Either way, finish it before lunch, because that's the last caffeine of the day.
- **Mid-morning: Red** juice.
- **Lunch:** oily fish or chicken over rice with greens and beans. Salmon goes in the air fryer at **200°C (390°F)** for about 8–10 minutes, until it flakes *(time is an estimate; thickness matters)*.
- **Before the gym:** a banana and water.
- **After the row: grape-mango** juice.
- **After the sauna: coconut water**, with something salty.
- **Early dinner: Green** juice with a light plate: a bowl of stew or leftover protein with plenty of vegetables.

All five: about 525 kcal, 62 g fruit sugar and ~10 g lactose, ฿124.0 *(juices from the labels, milk typical)*. With a plain 150 g Greek bowl in the milk's slot: about 545 kcal and ~6 g lactose, ฿144.4, before mix-ins.



A Rest Day

Keep the base, drop the sugar. **Milk (or a yogurt bowl), coconut water and one juice.**

- **Which juice?** Red on most rest days, for the potassium and zinc. Green if you want the probiotics and vitamin D.
- **Drop the grape-mango first.** It's the one that's just for pleasure, and the biggest sugar hit.
- **The numbers:** milk + coconut water + Red comes to about 305 kcal, 23 g fruit sugar, ~10 g lactose and ~1,330 mg potassium, for ฿65.0 *(juices from the labels, milk typical)*. That's well under the free-sugar guideline from page 11.
- **Yogurt day?** A plain yogurt bowl in the milk's slot works just as well; keep the drizzle to a thread (page 44).
- **Lean on the plate instead:** more greens, beans and a whole fruit to make up the fiber and vitamin C from the missing drinks.
- **Light training day?** Four drinks: keep both juices, skip the grape-mango. About 425 kcal, 38 g fruit sugar, ฿103.8.

Rule of thumb: let the day's work decide how many glasses you pour. *(The kitchen's judgment.)*



When to Drink What

- **Milk, a yogurt bowl or other protein after a swim.** Protein in the hour or two after training helps muscles repair. *(Well established that it helps; the exact window is looser than gyms claim.)*
- **Coconut water after the sauna.** You're replacing water and potassium. Add salt from food if you sweated hard.
- **Sweet drink after the hard part,** not before bed and not on an empty, idle afternoon.
- **Juice with food, not instead of it.** Fiber and food together blunt the sugar rush. *(Reasonably well established.)*
- **No caffeine after lunch.** Caffeine lingers for hours, and an early bedtime needs a clean afternoon. *(Well established.)*
- **Saving half the coffee?** Reheat and finish the second half before lunch, so the caffeine is gone by an early bedtime. The same goes for the flat white swap. If you save any of a milky coffee, keep it in the fridge, because milk shouldn't sit out for more than two hours.
- **A light, early dinner.** Finish eating two to three hours before sleep, so digestion isn't working the night shift. *(The kitchen's practical judgment, supported by sleep research.)*
- **Spread them out.** Five drinks across the day is easier on the stomach than three at lunch.



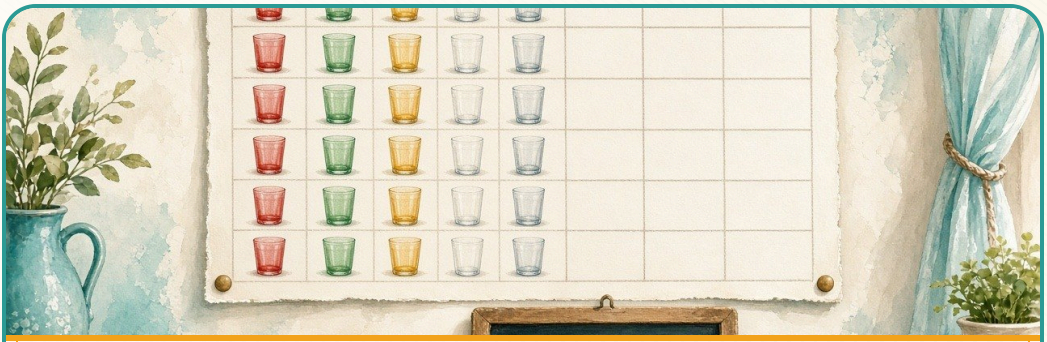
What It Costs, Drink by Drink

Prices in Thailand from house receipts. Online orders have the shipping spread across the boxes. "Per day" is one serving a day; a week is 7 days and a month is 30.

Drink	Pack price	Per serving	Per day	Per week	Per month
Red, 330 ml box	฿38.8 a box	฿38.8	฿38.8	฿271.6	฿1,164.0
Green, 330 ml box	฿38.8 a box	฿38.8	฿38.8	฿271.6	฿1,164.0
Grape-mango, 200 ml	฿101.2 per 1 L	฿20.2	฿20.2	฿141.7	฿607.2
Organic whole milk, 200 ml	฿95.0 per 2 L	฿9.5	฿9.5	฿66.5	฿285.0
Coconut water, 200 ml	฿83.3 per 1 L	฿16.7	฿16.7	฿116.6	฿499.8
Pinch hitter: **Greek yogurt, 150 g bowl**	฿399.0 per 2 kg	฿29.9	฿29.9	฿209.5	฿897.8

Weeks and months are worked out from the pack price, so they can be a few satang off seven or thirty times the rounded serving price.

The pattern: the two Malee boxes are 63% of a five-drink day. Milk is the bargain at ฿9.5 a glass, and the yogurt bowl costs about three glasses of milk before the toppings.



Days, Weeks and Months

Plan	Per day	Per week	Per month (30 days)
Training day, all five	฿124.0	฿868.0 (every day)	฿3,720.0 (every day)
Training day with a 150 g yogurt bowl instead of milk	฿144.4	฿1,011.0	฿4,332.8
Rest day: milk, coconut water and Red	฿65.0	฿454.7 (every day)	฿1,948.8 (every day)
Light day: four drinks, no grape-mango	฿103.8	฿726.3	฿3,112.8
Mixed week: 4 training + 3 rest days	฿98.7 on average	**฿690.9**	**฿2,960.9**
For comparison: **the house coffee, one double shot split into two cups**	฿50.0	฿350.0	฿1,500.0
For comparison: **the coffee swap, one short flat white a day**	~฿80.0 (estimate)	~฿560.0	~฿2,400.0

The mixed month keeps the same 4-to-3 ratio over 30 days.

Toppings are extra. A bowl like the house usual, with whey, collagen, berry powder and sunflower seeds stirred into 180 g of yogurt, comes to about ฿96.8. The yogurt is ฿35.9 of that and the toppings about ฿60.9 *(the whey and collagen prices are from receipts, the berry powder and seeds are estimates, and the probiotic isn't priced yet)*.



Five Drinks or One Plate?

How a five-drink day compares with what else the money buys.

Coffee, one cup:

Coffee	Price
The house coffee: robot-barista double-shot Americano, ฿50.0, split into two cups	**฿25.0 a cup, ฿50.0 a day** *(house receipt)*
The coffee swap: a short hot flat white, about 150–180 ml, at a Thai café	~฿80.0 *(estimate until there's a receipt)*
7-Eleven All Café latte	~฿45.0 (estimate)
Café Amazon latte	~฿55.0 (estimate)
Thai café latte	~฿80.0 *(estimate, for contrast)*

What the flat white brings: most of the cup is steamed whole milk, so about 80–100 kcal, 4–5 g of protein, 140–170 mg of calcium and 6–7 g of lactose *(typical values, estimate)*. That's roughly two-thirds of a glass of milk, so on a flat-white morning the coffee is already doing a little of drink #4's job. The Americano brings almost nothing but caffeine.

A proper plate, with carbs, meat and veg:

Plate	Price
Home-cooked: chicken and veg stir-fry over riceberry rice	฿29.7 for half the recipe *(house log; the sauces aren't priced)*
Home-cooked: freezer protein, rice and greens	~฿60.0 (estimate)
Street-food rice and meat plate	~฿60.0 (estimate)
Small chicken congee from the regular shop	฿49.0 *(house receipt)*
Congee from the regular shop, 3 for ฿232 with an herbal drink	about ฿77.3 each *(house receipt)*
Food-court meal	~฿80.0 (estimate)
Steak-house delivery, ฿278 for two meals	฿139.0 a meal *(house receipt)*
Takeaway salmon bento	฿319.0 *(house receipt)*

The honest answer: a full five-drink day (฿124.0) costs about as much as one and a half congees, or two street plates, and less than one delivery meal. A rest day (฿65.0) is about one street plate. The drinks don't replace a plate, though. They sit beside it. They pay off when they take the place of soft drinks, café drinks and snacks, and they don't when they're stacked on top of everything else. For scale, the house coffee habit is ฿50.0 a day, so a rest day of drinks costs a little more than the coffee, and a full five-drink day costs about two and a half coffee days. A daily flat white or café latte at about ฿80.0 (estimate) would cost more than the whole rest-day set of drinks. *(The kitchen's judgment.)*



Around the World

Can't find these brands? Look for the same *job*, not the same box. *(General guidance only. Brands, recipes and availability change by country, so always read the label.)*

Job	US	UK / EU
Red juice	V8 High Fiber where sold, or low-sodium V8 / tomato juice	Low-salt tomato or vegetable juice (e.g. Biotta)
Green juice	Cold-pressed green juice (check sugar)	Cold-pressed green juice
Sweet drink	100% grape-mango or mango blend juice	100% mango or grape juice, or a homemade mango lassi
Milk	Whole milk, organic if you like (US milk is usually vitamin D-fortified)	Whole milk (UK milk is usually not fortified with D)
Coconut water	Vita Coco, Harmless Harvest	Vita Coco, supermarket own brand

Job	Japan	Anywhere
Red juice	Kagome tomato or vegetable juice	Low-sodium tomato or mixed-vegetable juice
Green juice	Aojiru (kale or barley-grass drink)	Any green veg juice that's mostly vegetable
Sweet drink	100% mango or grape juice	Homemade mango lassi: mango, yogurt, ice
Milk	Fresh milk (gyunyu)	Plain fresh whole milk
Coconut water	Imported coconut water	Any 100% coconut water, or a fresh young coconut

Three label rules that work everywhere:

1. "100% juice" beats "nectar" or "drink."
2. Vegetable juices can be very salty. Look for "low sodium" or "no added salt."
3. Most juices have no added fiber. Without it, eat more whole veg and beans.



SECTION 4 · THE OLD WAYS, WITH PLUTARCH

The Old Ways

Drink, Bread and Restraint: How the Ancients Ate Lightly.

A historical section by Plutarch. Each vignette is marked RECORD (contemporary or near-contemporary documents), TRADITION (later or sacred sources that can't be checked) or LEGEND (good stories with weak evidence).

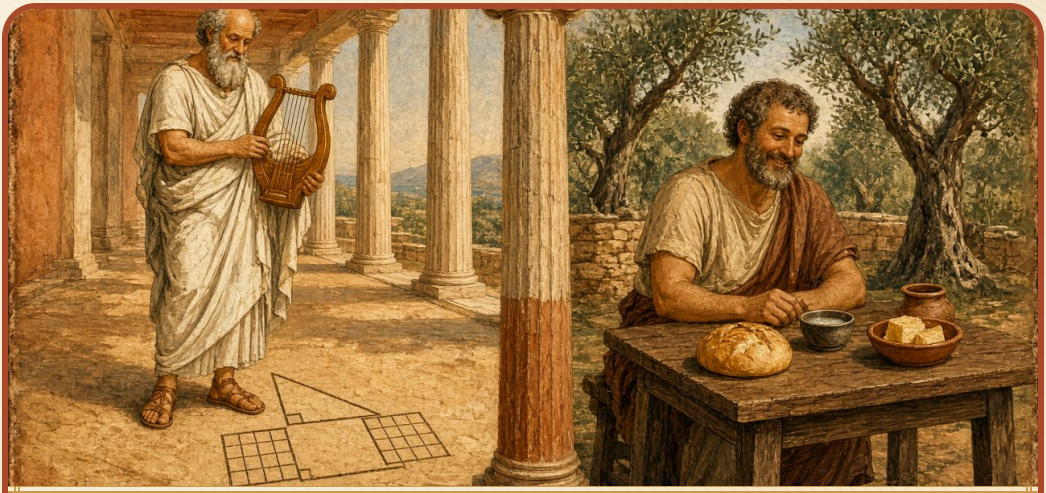
Nearly every philosophy and sect that tried to live well ended up writing a menu. What's striking is how often those menus came down to the same short list: something to drink, a grain or bread, a little dairy, fruit and greens. The details varied, and the reasons ranged from sensible to absurd, but the instinct is old.

1. Sparta: black broth and the common mess.

Every Spartan citizen ate at a shared mess, the *syssitia*, and paid in a fixed monthly ration of barley meal, wine, cheese and figs. The famous dish was *melas zomos*, black broth, made from pork, blood, salt and vinegar. My own *Life of Lycurgus* tells of a king who hired a Spartan cook to make it, hated it, and was told that to enjoy it he must first exercise and bathe in the river Eurotas, as the Spartans did.

RECORD for the mess and the ration; the anecdote is TRADITION.

> *Lesson: a fixed daily ration, eaten with appetite earned by work, beats variety for its own sake.*



The Old Ways (2)

2. Pythagoras: no meat, and no beans.

The Pythagoreans were known for avoiding meat (at least the strict members) and, famously, beans. The bean taboo is real in the ancient sources, though even they disagree about why, and Aristoxenus, who knew Pythagoreans personally, said Pythagoras rather liked beans. The story that he died rather than run across a bean field is **LEGEND**.

RECORD that the rules existed; their reasons and strictness are uncertain.

> *Lesson: diets have always carried taboos that are about identity more than nutrition, so know which of your rules are which.*

3. Epicurus and the Stoics: plain fare as freedom.

Epicurus, slandered for two thousand years as a glutton, actually lived on bread and water. In a surviving letter fragment he asks a friend to send "a little pot of cheese, so that I may feast when I like." The Stoic Musonius Rufus (1st century AD) taught that the best foods need no fire: fruit, greens, milk, cheese and honeycomb. Seneca recommended spending a few days each month on the coarsest bread and water, so that you would no longer fear poverty.

RECORD (Diogenes Laertius, Musonius' lectures, Seneca's *Letter 18*).

> *Lesson: a simple base diet makes a small luxury, like the cheese, a real pleasure.*



The Old Ways (3)

4. Daniel and the Essenes: pulse, water and one dish.

In the Book of Daniel, the young captives in Babylon refuse the king's rich food and wine. They ask for ten days of "pulse" (the Hebrew means vegetables or seeds) and water, and come out looking healthier than the court youths. Josephus describes the Essenes of the first century: after prayer, each received bread and a single dish, eaten in silence.

Daniel is **TRADITION**; the Essene meal is **RECORD** (Josephus, *Jewish War* II.8).

> *Lesson: one plate and water, eaten deliberately, was a holy ideal long before it was a health idea.*

5. The Rule of St Benedict: the ration, written down.

Benedict (c. 530) set out exactly what a monk eats each day: two cooked dishes, so that anyone who can't eat one has the other, plus fruit or fresh vegetables when available, a pound of bread, and a *hemina* of wine (roughly a quarter litre to half a litre; the exact amount is disputed). The meat of four-footed animals was forbidden except to the sick. The desert monks of Egypt before him went much further, some living mostly on bread, salt and water.

RECORD (*Rule*, chapters 39 and 40).

> *Lesson: a written daily standard with a built-in backup option is what makes a simple diet last for centuries.*



The Old Ways (4)

6. Taoist "avoiding grains."

Chinese longevity traditions developed *bigu*, giving up grains, along with breathing exercises and herbal foods. A manual titled *Discarding Grain and Eating Qi* was found in a tomb at Mawangdui, sealed in 168 BC. Stories of immortals who lived on dew, mist and air alone are LEGEND.

RECORD that the practice and manuals existed; claims of extraordinary lifespans are not.

> *Lesson: the drive to cut a diet down to almost nothing is ancient, but the dramatic results are always reported about someone else.*

7. Luigi Cornaro: the Venetian who weighed his food.

After a dissolute youth left him ill in middle age, the Venetian nobleman Cornaro limited himself to about 12 ounces of food and 14 ounces of wine a day. His *Discourses on the Sober Life* (from 1558) became a bestseller across Europe for three centuries. He claimed to be in his nineties; his birth year (1464 or 1484) is disputed, so the exact age is uncertain.

RECORD for the book and the regimen; his age is uncertain.

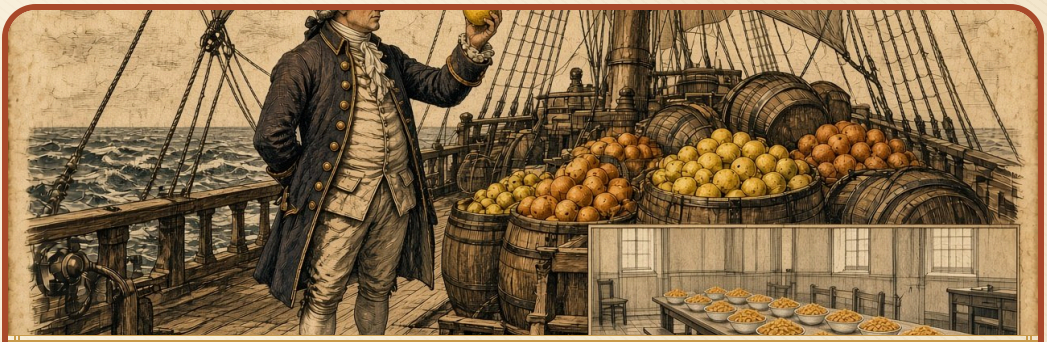
> *Lesson: measured portions, eaten every day, were Europe's first popular "longevity diet," and its appeal was steadiness, not novelty.*

8. The Maasai and the Mongols: herders who drank their meals.

Traditional Maasai herders lived largely on milk, with blood drawn from a living cow's neck vein and meat on occasion. Twentieth-century researchers studied them precisely because such a diet seemed impossible to thrive on. The friar William of Rubruck, visiting the Mongols in 1253, described *airag* (fermented mare's milk) as their summer staple, sharp on the tongue and leaving a taste of almond milk. Marco Polo's claim that riders on campaign lived on horse blood and dried milk paste is plausible but less reliable.

RECORD (Rubruck; modern ethnography); Polo's details are PARTLY LEGEND.

> *Lesson: whole peoples have lived on milk as the main thing they drank, but they drank it with plenty of daily work and no processed food.*



The Old Ways (5)

9. The Royal Navy and scurvy: which juice matters.

In 1747 James Lind, a naval surgeon on HMS *Salisbury*, split 12 scurvy-stricken sailors into pairs and tested six remedies. The pair given oranges and lemons recovered fastest. It took until 1795, pushed by Gilbert Blane, for the Admiralty to issue lemon juice across the fleet. Later it switched to cheaper West Indian lime juice, which has far less vitamin C, and was often stored badly. Scurvy came back, notably on the 1875 Arctic expedition.

RECORD.

> *Lesson: a juice is only as good as its fruit and its freshness; don't assume one juice can stand in for another.*

10. Graham and Kellogg: the American health crusade.

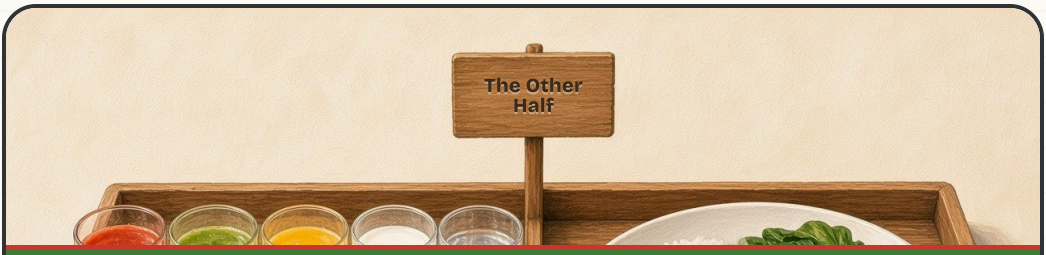
In the 1830s the preacher Sylvester Graham preached against meat, spices, alcohol and white flour, and urged coarse whole-wheat bread; the sugary modern graham cracker would have appalled him. John Harvey Kellogg ran the Battle Creek Sanitarium on bland vegetarian food, nuts and yogurt, and with his brother developed flaked cereals in the 1890s. Kellogg did preach that a bland diet curbed sexual appetites, but the popular claim that corn flakes were invented as an anti-masturbation food is overstated:
LEGEND built on a real belief.

RECORD for both men's programmes.

> *Lesson: good advice, like whole grains and fewer stimulants, often arrives packaged with crankery, so keep the first and drop the second.*

The through-line: across 2,500 years, the regimens that lasted were simple, measured and repeatable: a fixed drink, a fixed bread or grain, a little dairy and fresh produce. The ones that promised miracles, from living on dew to cereal as virtue, are remembered as curiosities.

Historical practice is not medical evidence; nutrition claims in 5 Alive should rest on modern sources.



The Other Half

Five drinks cover the vitamin C, a good share of the potassium, and the calcium from the milk. They don't cover the rest: real protein, omega-3, iron, zinc, slow starch and fiber you chew. That's the job of the plate. So here's the other half of the book. It's three short lists of ten simple foods, sold almost anywhere in the world, so you can keep changing what's on the plate without having to think about it.

The three lists: 10 carbs · 10 meats and fish · 10 vegetables and fruits.

Each food gets:

- **A typical serving** and its numbers per serving *(approximate, from USDA FoodData Central typical values; not labels)*: kcal, protein, carbs split into starch, fiber and sugar, fat and omega-3, and the 3–4 micros it's best at. None of these foods has lactose. Added sugar is 0 for all of them except shop bread, which may have 1–3 g.
- **Five scores:**
  - **Nutrition, out of 10:** how much it brings per serving, with a one-line reason.
  - **Cost, out of 10:** 10 = ฿5 or less a serving, 9 = up to ฿15, 8 = up to ฿25, 7 = up to ฿40, 6 = up to ฿60, 5 = up to ฿80, 4 = up to ฿100. Prices are from Thai house receipts where we have them, and everything else is marked **(estimate)**.
  - **Ease, out of 10:** 10 = open it or eat it as it is. Cook times are for the air fryer, Instant Pot, wok or rice cooker.
  - **Travel, out of 10:** how easy it is to find in an ordinary supermarket in most countries.
  - **Digestion, 1–10, on the recovery scale: 1 is easiest** on the stomach. Lower is gentler.
- **What it fills that the five drinks don't.**

*At the end: the **build-a-plate rule**, a **weekly variety rule** and seven plates in the house's healthy-soul style.*



Carbs (1)

Your fuel tank. Pick one per plate. Beans count here, as a carb and fiber source.

1 White jasmine rice 150 g cooked (about ¾ cup)

195 kcal · 4 g protein · carbs 42 g (starch ~41 g, fiber 0.6 g, sugar ~0) · fat 0.4 g, omega-3 0

Standouts: manganese, a little selenium and folate. That's about it.

NUTRITION 3/10: clean, fast energy, but very little else. | COST 10 (~฿2.7, estimate; the house hasn't priced white rice yet) | EASE 9 (rice cooker 20–25 min; Instant Pot 4 min plus 10 min release) | TRAVEL 10 | DIGESTION ↓1

Fills: the fast glycogen refill after hard training, the easy way. Home-cooked only: it comes out of the house rice cooker.

2 Brown or riceberry rice 150 g cooked

185 kcal · 4 g protein · carbs 38 g (starch ~35 g, fiber 2.7 g, sugar <1 g) · fat 1.5 g, omega-3 ~0

Standouts: magnesium (~65 mg), manganese, selenium, vitamin B1. Riceberry adds purple anthocyanins.

NUTRITION 6/10: the same rice, with the bran and its minerals left on. | COST 9 (฿5.2, house price for riceberry) | EASE 8 (rice cooker brown setting ~45 min; Instant Pot 22 min plus 10 min release) | TRAVEL 7 (brown rice is everywhere, riceberry mostly in Asia) | DIGESTION ↓4

Fills: slow starch and magnesium.

3 Potato, skin on 200 g (one medium)

186 kcal · 5 g protein · carbs 42 g (starch ~36 g, fiber 4.4 g, natural sugar ~2 g) · fat 0.3 g, omega-3 0

Standouts: potassium (~1,070 mg), vitamin B6, vitamin C (~19 mg).

NUTRITION 7/10: a potassium powerhouse that most people underrate. | COST 9 (฿12.4, house price) | EASE 8 (air fryer wedges at 200°C (390°F) for 20–25 min; Instant Pot, whole, 12–15 min) | TRAVEL 10 | DIGESTION ↓2 (boiled or mashed), 3 with the skin

Fills: B6, and more potassium on a day without coconut water.

4 Sweet potato (orange) 200 g (one medium)

180 kcal · 4 g protein · carbs 41 g (starch ~22 g, fiber 6.6 g, natural sugar ~13 g) · fat 0.3 g, omega-3 0

Standouts: vitamin A (~1,900 µg, about two days' worth), potassium (~950 mg), vitamin C, manganese. The purple kind has less vitamin A and more anthocyanins.

NUTRITION 9/10: the vitamin A champion, with real fiber. | COST 9 (฿11.6, house price for purple sweet potato) | EASE 8 (air fryer cubes at 200°C (390°F) for 15–18 min, or whole for 35–40 min; Instant Pot 15–18 min) | TRAVEL 9 | DIGESTION ↓3

Fills: vitamin A without the juice sugar.

5 Oats (rolled or instant) 40 g dry

150 kcal · 5 g protein · carbs 27 g (starch ~22 g, fiber 4 g, sugar <1 g) · fat 2.6 g, omega-3 ~0

Standouts: beta-glucan fiber, manganese, magnesium (~55 mg), zinc, iron.

NUTRITION 7/10: the most minerals and soluble fiber per baht. | COST 9 (~฿6.4, estimate) | EASE 10 (5 min on the stove, 3 min in a mug, or soaked overnight) | TRAVEL 9 | DIGESTION ↓3

Fills: zinc, iron and the gut-friendly fiber that juices don't have.



Carbs (2)

6 Whole-wheat bread or sourdough 2 slices (~70 g)

175 kcal · 9 g protein · carbs 30 g (starch ~22 g, fiber 4–5 g whole-wheat or ~2 g white sourdough, sugar 1–3 g, possibly added) · fat 2.5 g, omega-3 ~0

Standouts: selenium, manganese, B vitamins, a little iron.

NUTRITION 5/10: whole-wheat brings the fiber; sourdough brings the gentler gut. Best of all is whole-wheat sourdough. | COST 9 (~฿15.0, estimate, bakery loaf) | EASE 10 (toast it, done) | TRAVEL 9 | DIGESTION ↓3

Fills: selenium and B vitamins, in the most portable carb on the list.

7 Rice noodles 150 g cooked

160 kcal · 3 g protein · carbs 36 g (starch ~35 g, fiber 1.5 g, sugar 0) · fat 0.3 g, omega-3 0

Standouts: almost none. A little selenium and manganese.

NUTRITION 2/10: pure, easy fuel, with nothing else on board. | COST 10 (~฿5.0, estimate) | EASE 9 (soak or boil 3–5 min, then 1 min in the wok) | TRAVEL 7 | DIGESTION ↓1

Fills: a soup or stir-fry carb for days when your stomach wants it simple.

8 Soba (buckwheat noodles) 150 g cooked

150 kcal · 7.6 g protein · carbs 32 g (starch ~30 g, fiber ~2 g (estimate), sugar ~0) · fat 0.2 g, omega-3 0

Standouts: manganese, vitamin B1, magnesium. Most shop soba is half wheat; look for "100% buckwheat" for more minerals. Dry soba can be salty, so rinse it after cooking.

NUTRITION 5/10: more protein and minerals than any other noodle here. | COST 7 (~฿30.0, estimate, imported pack) | EASE 8 (boil 4–5 min, rinse cold) | TRAVEL 6 | DIGESTION ↓2

Fills: manganese and B1. A cold-noodle change from rice.

9 Corn 1 ear (~100 g kernels)

96 kcal · 3.4 g protein · carbs 21 g (starch ~14 g, fiber 2.4 g, natural sugar ~4.5 g) · fat 1.5 g, omega-3 0

Standouts: lutein and zeaxanthin (eye pigments), folate, vitamin B1, magnesium.

NUTRITION 5/10: the light carb, with eye-friendly pigments. | COST 9 (~฿15.0, estimate, fresh; canned organic ฿26.5 per 100 g at house prices) | EASE 9 (Instant Pot 3 min; air fryer at 200°C (390°F) for 10–12 min) | TRAVEL 9 | DIGESTION ↓5 (the skins pass straight through)

Fills: lutein, which none of the five drinks has much of.

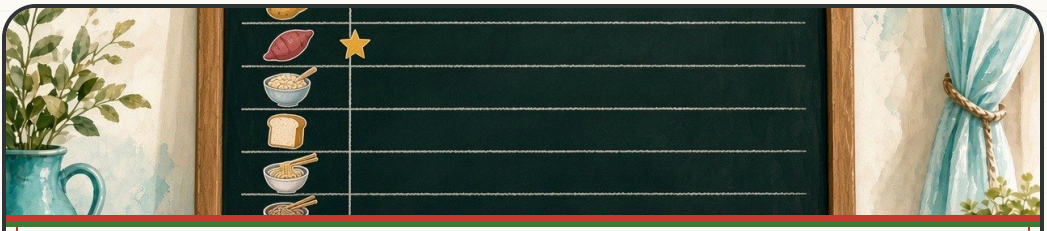
10 Navy, black or kidney beans ½ cup cooked (~90 g)

~115–127 kcal · ~7.5 g protein (a bonus, not the plate's protein) · carbs ~21–24 g (starch ~12 g, fiber 7.5–9.6 g, sugar <1 g) · fat 0.5 g, omega-3 ~0.1 g

Standouts: folate (~130 µg), magnesium (~60 mg), iron (~2 mg), potassium.

NUTRITION 9/10: the most fiber and folate on any list in this book. | COST 9 (navy, dried, ฿6.3, house price; black, canned, about ฿16.4) | EASE 6 (canned: 0 min. Dried, soaked overnight: Instant Pot 8–10 min plus natural release. **Kidney beans must be fully cooked:** never slow-cook raw kidney beans) | TRAVEL 8 | DIGESTION ↓6 (start with small portions, rinse canned beans, and cook dried ones fully)

Fills: whole-food fiber, as opposed to added-back fiber, plus folate and iron.



Carbs Compared

#	Carb (serving)	kcal	Fiber	Nutrition	Cost (฿)
1	White rice, 150 g	195	0.6 g	3	10 (~2.7 *est.*)
2	Brown or riceberry rice, 150 g	185	2.7 g	6	9 (5.2)
3	Potato, 200 g	186	4.4 g	7	9 (12.4)
4	Sweet potato, 200 g	180	6.6 g	9	9 (11.6)
5	Oats, 40 g dry	150	4 g	7	9 (~6.4 *est.*)
6	Whole-wheat or sourdough, 2 slices	175	2–5 g	5	9 (~15.0 *est.*)
7	Rice noodles, 150 g	160	1.5 g	2	10 (~5.0 *est.*)
8	Soba, 150 g	150	~2 g	5	7 (~30.0 *est.*)
9	Corn, 1 ear	96	2.4 g	5	9 (~15.0 *est.*)
10	Navy, black or kidney beans, ½ cup	~120	7.5–9.6 g	9	9 (6.3)

#	Carb (serving)	Ease	Travel	Digestion	What it fills that the drinks don't
1	White rice, 150 g	9	10	1	Fast glycogen refill
2	Brown or riceberry rice, 150 g	8	7	4	Magnesium, slow starch
3	Potato, 200 g	8	10	2	B6, extra potassium
4	Sweet potato, 200 g	8	9	3	Vitamin A without juice sugar
5	Oats, 40 g dry	10	9	3	Zinc, iron, beta-glucan
6	Whole-wheat or sourdough, 2 slices	10	9	3	Selenium, B vitamins
7	Rice noodles, 150 g	9	7	1	Easy soup carb
8	Soba, 150 g	9	6	2	Manganese, B1
9	Corn, 1 ear	9	9	5	Lutein
10	Navy, black or kidney beans, ½ cup	6	8	6	Real fiber, folate, iron

Top picks:

- **Everyday champion:** sweet potato, for vitamin A, fiber and an easy air fryer.
- **The fiber king:** beans. Add half a portion to any plate.
- **Recovery carb:** white rice, easiest on a tired stomach after a hard session.
- **Best value:** oats and potatoes.

The swap rule: on a training day, lean on rice, potato and noodles. On a rest day, lean on beans, oats and sweet potato, which have more fiber per kcal.



Meat & Fish (1)

The protein list: meat and fish only. One palm per plate, about 100 g cooked (about 130 g raw). Costs are per serving, at the raw weight. *(Eggs stay hidden in dishes: stirred into congee, bound into fish cakes, tossed through fried rice. They add choline and B12 without being the star.)*

1 Salmon 100 g cooked

206 kcal · 22 g protein · carbs 0 · fat 12 g, **omega-3 (EPA + DHA) ~2 g**

Standouts: vitamin D (~13 µg, about a day's worth), B12, selenium, niacin.

NUTRITION 10/10: the omega-3 and vitamin D that the drinks have none of. COST 4 (฿84.5 for frozen coho slices, house price; **salmon belly ฿31.1**, house price, which scores 7) EASE 10 (air fryer at 200°C (390°F) for 8–10 min) TRAVEL 9 DIGESTION ↓2

Fills: omega-3 and vitamin D. The single most important fish here.

2 Mackerel / saba 100 g cooked

262 kcal · 24 g protein · carbs 0 · fat 18 g, **omega-3 ~1.2–2.5 g** (Norwegian saba is at the high end)

Standouts: vitamin B12 (~19 µg, many days' worth), vitamin D, selenium, niacin.

NUTRITION 10/10: salmon's omega-3 at a fraction of the price. COST 7 (~฿40.0, estimate, frozen saba fillet) EASE 9 (air fryer, skin-side up, at 200°C (390°F) for 10–12 min) TRAVEL 8 DIGESTION ↓3 (oily and rich)

Fills: omega-3, vitamin D and a huge dose of B12.

3 Sardines, canned in olive oil 1 can, drained (~90 g)

191 kcal · 23 g protein · carbs 0 · fat 10 g, **omega-3 ~1 g**

Standouts: calcium (~350 mg, from the soft bones), vitamin D, B12, selenium.

NUTRITION 9/10: omega-3 plus calcium, with no cooking at all. COST 5 (฿60.5 a can, house price) EASE 10 (open the can) TRAVEL 10 DIGESTION ↓3

Fills: omega-3, and calcium on a day without milk.

4 Canned tuna (light, in water) 1 can, drained (~100 g)

116 kcal · 26 g protein · carbs 0 · fat 0.8 g, omega-3 ~0.3 g

Standouts: selenium (~80 µg, more than a day's worth), niacin, B12, a little vitamin D.

NUTRITION 6/10: lean, cheap protein, but little of the omega-3 the oily fish bring. COST 7 (~฿35.0, estimate) EASE 10 TRAVEL 10 DIGESTION ↓2

Fills: selenium. Choose light or skipjack tuna and keep it to two or three cans a week; albacore carries more mercury.

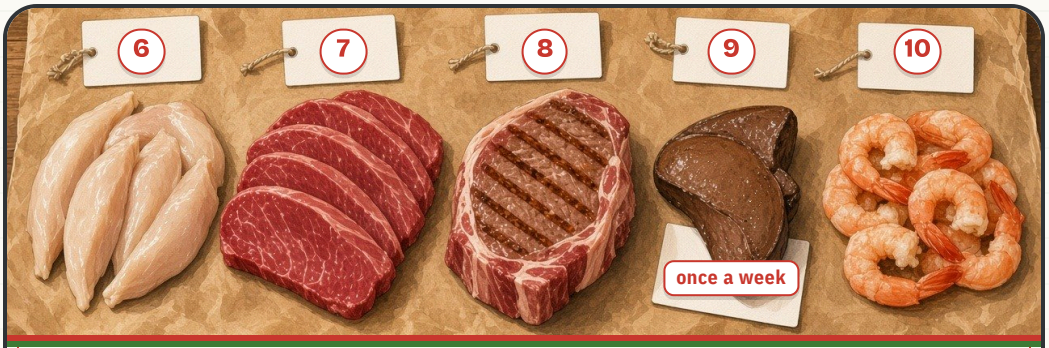
5 Chicken thigh, skinless 100 g cooked

209 kcal · 26 g protein · carbs 0 · fat 11 g, omega-3 ~0.1 g

Standouts: zinc (~2.4 mg), niacin, vitamin B6, selenium. It has more zinc and iron than breast.

NUTRITION 6/10: juicy, forgiving, and a bit more mineral-rich than breast. COST 8 (฿18.5, house price, boneless) EASE 9 (air fryer at 200°C (390°F) for 18–22 min; Instant Pot 8–10 min; wok, sliced, 6–8 min) TRAVEL 10 DIGESTION ↓3

Fills: zinc and protein at the price of a coffee.



Meat & Fish (2)

6 Chicken breast or tenderloin 100 g cooked

165 kcal · **31 g protein** · carbs 0 · fat 3.6 g, omega-3 ~0

Standouts: niacin (~14 mg), vitamin B6, selenium, phosphorus.

NUTRITION 5/10: the most protein per kcal on the list, but light on minerals. **COST 9** (฿14.3, house price for frozen tenderloin) **EASE 9** (air fryer at 190°C (375°F) for 15–18 min, or 10–12 min for tenderloins; wok 5 min) **TRAVEL 10** **DIGESTION ↓2**

Fills: lean protein when the day's calories are tight.

7 Lean beef (sirloin) 100 g cooked

~195 kcal · 29 g protein · carbs 0 · fat 8 g, omega-3 ~0.05 g (a little more if grass-fed)

Standouts: zinc (~5.5 mg, half a day's worth), heme iron (~2.6 mg, the well-absorbed kind), B12, selenium.

NUTRITION 8/10: the best everyday source of iron and zinc. **COST 6** (฿49.4, house price for frozen sliced sirloin) **EASE 9** (wok, thin slices, 2–3 min; air fryer steak at 200°C (390°F) for 10–14 min) **TRAVEL 9** **DIGESTION ↓5**

Fills: iron and zinc, the two the drinks have almost none of.

8 Pork loin 100 g cooked

~190 kcal · 27 g protein · carbs 0 · fat 8 g, omega-3 ~0

Standouts: vitamin B1 (~0.9 mg, about three-quarters of a day), selenium, vitamin B6, zinc.

NUTRITION 7/10: the vitamin B1 champion of all foods. **COST 8** (~฿22.0, estimate, raw loin; the only house price is ready-roasted loin at ฿0.85 a gram) **EASE 8** (air fryer chops at 200°C (390°F) for 12–15 min; wok, sliced, 4–5 min) **TRAVEL 9** **DIGESTION ↓4**

Fills: vitamin B1 for turning all that carb into energy.

Meat & Fish (2) *(continued)*

9 Liver (beef, pork or chicken), once a week 75 g cooked

~130 kcal · 20 g protein · carbs ~4 g (stored glycogen, not fiber or sugar) · fat 3.5 g, omega-3 trace

Standouts: vitamin A (several days' worth in one serving), B12 (dozens of days' worth), copper, iron, folate. *(Beef liver figures; chicken liver has less vitamin A and more folate and iron.)*

NUTRITION 10/10: nature's multivitamin, which is exactly why it's **once a week**: the vitamin A builds up. **COST 9** (~฿12.0, estimate; not priced in the house kitchen yet) **EASE 7** (pan or wok, 2–3 min a side; stop while it's still just pink inside, or it turns to leather) **TRAVEL 8** **DIGESTION ↓4**

Fills: vitamin A, copper and B12 in one go. Ask a doctor first if you're on vitamin A supplements.

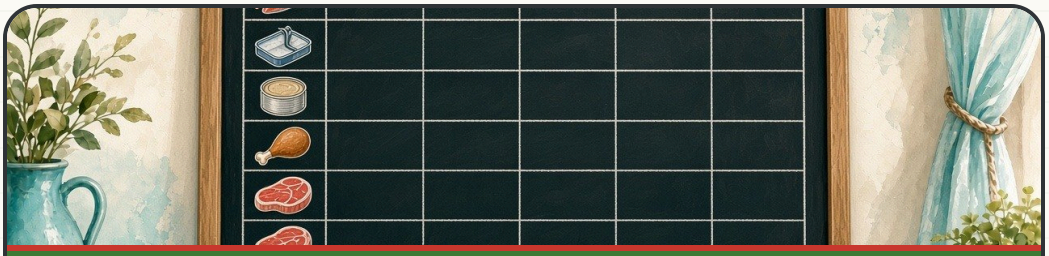
10 Shrimp 100 g cooked

99 kcal · 24 g protein · carbs 0 · fat 0.3 g, omega-3 ~0.3 g

Standouts: selenium (~40 µg), iodine, choline, vitamin B12.

NUTRITION 6/10: very lean, with iodine and selenium as a bonus. **COST 6** (~฿50.0, estimate, peeled frozen) **EASE 10** (wok 3 min; air fryer at 200°C (390°F) for 6–8 min) **TRAVEL 9** **DIGESTION ↓2**

Fills: iodine and selenium with almost no fat.



Meat & Fish Compared

#	Meat or fish (serving)	kcal	Protein	Omega-3	Nutrition	Cost (฿)
1	Salmon, 100 g	206	22 g	~2 g	10	4 (84.5; belly 31.1)
2	Mackerel / saba, 100 g	262	24 g	1.2–2.5 g	10	7 (~40.0 *est.*)
3	Sardines, 1 can	191	23 g	~1 g	9	5 (60.5)
4	Canned light tuna, 1 can	116	26 g	~0.3 g	6	7 (~35.0 *est.*)
5	Chicken thigh, 100 g	209	26 g	~0.1 g	6	8 (18.5)
6	Chicken breast, 100 g	165	**31 g**	~0	5	9 (14.3)
7	Lean beef, 100 g	~195	29 g	~0.05 g	8	6 (49.4)
8	Pork loin, 100 g	~190	27 g	~0	7	8 (~22.0 *est.*)
9	Liver, 75 g, weekly	~130	20 g	trace	10	9 (~12.0 *est.*)
10	Shrimp, 100 g	99	24 g	~0.3 g	6	6 (~50.0 *est.*)

#	Meat or fish (serving)	Ease	Travel	Digestion	What it fills that the drinks don't
1	Salmon, 100 g	10	9	2	Omega-3, vitamin D
2	Mackerel / saba, 100 g	9	8	3	Omega-3, D, B12
3	Sardines, 1 can	10	10	3	Omega-3, calcium
4	Canned light tuna, 1 can	10	10	2	Selenium
5	Chicken thigh, 100 g	9	10	3	Zinc
6	Chicken breast, 100 g	9	10	2	Lean protein
7	Lean beef, 100 g	9	9	5	Heme iron, zinc
8	Pork loin, 100 g	8	9	4	Vitamin B1
9	Liver, 75 g, weekly	7	8	4	Vitamin A, copper, B12
10	Shrimp, 100 g	10	9	2	Iodine, selenium

Top picks:

- **The must-haves:** salmon or saba, twice a week. They're the only real fix for the omega-3 gap.
- **Best value:** saba, salmon belly and sardines for omega-3; chicken thigh and breast for everyday protein.
- **Mineral pick:** lean beef, once or twice a week, for iron and zinc.
- **The weekly ritual:** liver, one small serving, no more.
- **Easiest after training:** salmon, chicken breast or shrimp, which score 2 on digestion.



Vegetables & Fruit (1)

Two handfuls of vegetables per plate, and one whole fruit a day. The drinks already bring plenty of vitamin C and potassium, so this list leans on what they **don't** bring: vitamin K, folate, calcium from greens, cabbage-family compounds, and fiber you chew. Each serving is about 100 g unless it says otherwise.

1 Bok choy 1 cup cooked (~170 g)

20 kcal · 2.7 g protein · carbs 3 g (fiber 1.7 g, natural sugar 1.4 g) · fat 0.3 g

Standouts: calcium (~160 mg, and well absorbed), vitamin A, vitamin K, folate.

NUTRITION 8/10: the greens with calcium your body can actually use. COST 9 (~฿8.5, estimate; not priced in the house kitchen yet) EASE 10 (wok with garlic, 2–3 min) TRAVEL 8 DIGESTION ↓2

Fills: calcium and vitamin K on the plate.

2 Broccoli 100 g

35 kcal · 2.4 g protein · carbs 7 g (fiber 3.3 g, natural sugar 1.4 g, starch ~2 g) · fat 0.4 g, omega-3 ~0.1 g

Standouts: vitamin K (~140 µg), folate (~110 µg), vitamin C, sulforaphane (a cabbage-family compound).

NUTRITION 9/10: the all-rounder of the vegetable world. COST 9 (฿9.2, house price) EASE 9 (air fryer at 190°C (375°F) for 8–10 min; steam 4–5 min; Instant Pot 0–1 min) TRAVEL 10 DIGESTION ↓5 (it can be gassy)

Fills: vitamin K, folate and sulforaphane.

3 Spinach or kale 100 g raw (two big handfuls; it cooks down)

23 kcal · 2.9 g protein · carbs 3.6 g (fiber 2.2 g, sugar 0.4 g) · fat 0.4 g, omega-3 ~0.1 g *(spinach figures)*

Standouts: vitamin K (~480 µg, many days' worth), folate (~190 µg), magnesium (~80 mg), vitamin A. *(Spinach iron is the poorly absorbed kind.)*

NUTRITION 9/10: the most vitamin K and folate per kcal of anything here. COST 8 (฿19.9 for kale at house prices; local spinach ~฿15.0, estimate) EASE 10 (wilt 1–2 min; kale chips in the air fryer at 160°C (320°F) for 5–7 min) TRAVEL 9 DIGESTION ↓3 (cooked spinach), 4 (kale)

Fills: vitamin K, folate and magnesium. Ask a doctor first if you take warfarin.

Vegetables & Fruit (1) *(continued)*

4 Carrots 100 g (one large)

41 kcal · 0.9 g protein · carbs 9.6 g (natural sugar 4.7 g, fiber 2.8 g, starch ~1.4 g) · fat 0.2 g

Standouts: vitamin A (~835 µg), vitamin K, potassium, fiber.

NUTRITION 7/10: vitamin A you chew, with fiber. **COST 10** (฿1.6, house price, the cheapest food in the book) **EASE 9** (raw sticks; air fryer at 200°C (390°F) for 15–18 min; Instant Pot 3 min) **TRAVEL 10** **DIGESTION ↓3** (cooked)

Fills: chewing and fiber. Its vitamin A partly doubles up with the juices; that's fine, because the carrot kind (beta-carotene) doesn't build up.

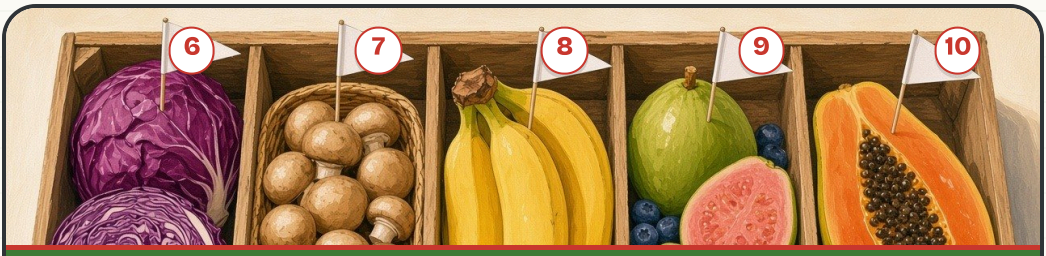
5 Tomato 1 medium (~120 g)

22 kcal · 1.1 g protein · carbs 4.7 g (natural sugar 3.2 g, fiber 1.4 g) · fat 0.2 g

Standouts: lycopene (better absorbed when cooked with a little oil), potassium, vitamin C, vitamin K.

NUTRITION 6/10: lycopene is the star; the rest is modest. **COST 9** (~฿6.0, estimate; crushed tinned tomatoes ฿0.16 a gram at house prices) **EASE 10** **TRAVEL 10** **DIGESTION ↓3** (acidic for some)

Fills: lycopene, the red pigment the juice boxes don't promise.



Vegetables & Fruit (2)

6 Cabbage (green, white or red) 100 g

25 kcal · 1.3 g protein · carbs 5.8 g (natural sugar 3.2 g, fiber 2.5 g) · fat 0.1 g

Standouts: vitamin K (~76 µg), vitamin C, folate, cabbage-family compounds. Red cabbage adds anthocyanins.

NUTRITION 7/10: cheap, crunchy, and keeps for weeks in the fridge. COST 10 (~฿3.0, estimate) EASE 9 (wok 3–4 min; raw slaw in 2 min) TRAVEL 10 DIGESTION ↓6 raw, 4 cooked

Fills: vitamin K and crunch. Sauerkraut or kimchi, as a side, add live cultures too.

Swap-in: green beans · 100 g cooked: 35 kcal · 1.9 g protein · carbs 7.9 g (fiber 3.2 g, natural sugar 1.5 g) · fat 0.3 g · vitamin K (~48 µg), folate, vitamin C, vitamin A *(approx.)*. ฿8.6, house price. Wok 4–5 min, or air fryer at 200°C (390°F) for 8–10 min. Scores about the same as cabbage, with a gentler digestion score of 3.

7 Mushrooms 100 g cooked

28 kcal · 2.2 g protein · carbs 5.3 g (fiber 2.2 g, natural sugar 2.3 g) · fat 0.5 g

Standouts: selenium, vitamin B2, niacin, potassium. Mushrooms left in the sun or UV-treated also bring vitamin D.

NUTRITION 6/10: B vitamins and deep savoury flavour. COST 7 (฿32.0 for button mushrooms, house price; Thai market straw or oyster mushrooms are cheaper) EASE 9 (air fryer at 200°C (390°F) for 8–10 min; wok 4 min) TRAVEL 9 DIGESTION ↓4

Fills: vitamin B2 and selenium, plus the meaty flavour that makes a plate feel finished.

8 Banana 1 medium (~118 g)

105 kcal · 1.3 g protein · carbs 27 g (**fruit sugar 14 g**, fiber 3.1 g, starch ~6 g, more when slightly green) · fat 0.4 g

Standouts: potassium (~420 mg), vitamin B6, magnesium, vitamin C.

NUTRITION 6/10: the ultimate pre- or post-training snack. COST 9 (฿12.0 each, house price) EASE 10 TRAVEL 10 DIGESTION ↓1 (ripe)

Fills: B6 and quick fuel you can chew. Its potassium overlaps with coconut water, so on a coconut-water day, think of it as fuel.

Vegetables & Fruit (2) *(continued)*

9 Guava (or berries) 100 g

68 kcal · 2.6 g protein · carbs 14 g (**fruit sugar 9 g**, **fiber 5.4 g**) · fat 1 g *(guava figures)*

Standouts: fiber, vitamin C (~230 mg, a lot), folate, potassium. Berries (75 g blueberries: 43 kcal, 1.8 g fiber) bring anthocyanins instead.

NUTRITION 9/10: the most fiber of any fruit here, for very little sugar. | COST 9 (~฿10.0, estimate, Thai guava; imported blueberries ฿51.0 for 75 g at house prices, which scores 6) | EASE 10 | TRAVEL 6 for guava (tropical), 9 for frozen berries | DIGESTION ↓5 (seeds and fiber)

Fills: chewed fruit fiber. The vitamin C doubles up with the juices, so eat guava for the fiber.

10 Papaya (or an orange) 1 cup cubed (~145 g)

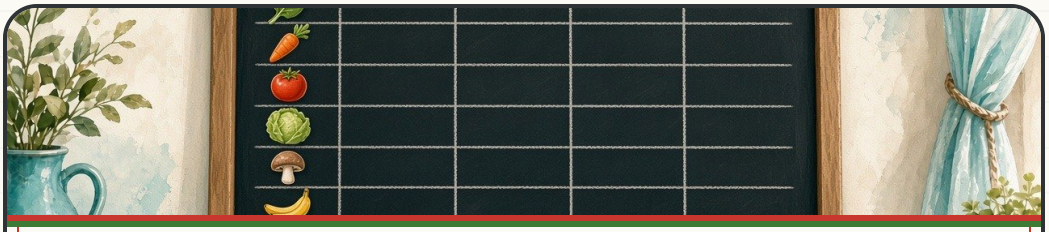
62 kcal · 0.7 g protein · carbs 16 g (**fruit sugar 11 g**, fiber 2.5 g) · fat 0.4 g

Standouts: folate, vitamin C, lycopene, papain (a natural enzyme). An orange gives similar vitamin C, plus a bit more fiber.

NUTRITION 7/10: the gentlest fruit on the list, and good for a heavy day. | COST 10 (~฿5.0, estimate, at a Thai market; the house's organic papaya ฿45.0, which scores 6; Taiwan oranges about ฿7.2 each at house prices) | EASE 10 | TRAVEL 7 | DIGESTION ↓1

Fills: folate and a soft finish to a meal.

Fruit sugar from whole fruit isn't counted as free sugar the way juice is, because the fiber's still inside.



Vegetables & Fruit Compared

#	Veg or fruit (serving)	kcal	Fiber	Nutrition	Cost (฿)
1	Bok choy, 1 cup cooked	20	1.7 g	8	9 (~8.5 *est.*)
2	Broccoli, 100 g	35	3.3 g	9	9 (9.2)
3	Spinach or kale, 100 g raw	23	2.2 g	9	8 (19.9)
4	Carrots, 100 g	41	2.8 g	7	10 (1.6)
5	Tomato, 1 medium	22	1.4 g	6	9 (~6.0 *est.*)
6	Cabbage, 100 g	25	2.5 g	7	10 (~3.0 *est.*)
7	Mushrooms, 100 g	28	2.2 g	6	7 (32.0)
8	Banana, 1 medium	105	3.1 g	6	9 (12.0)
9	Guava (or berries), 100 g	68	**5.4 g**	9	9 (~10.0 *est.*)
10	Papaya (or orange), 1 cup	62	2.5 g	7	10 (~5.0 *est.*)

#	Veg or fruit (serving)	Ease	Travel	Digestion	What it fills that the drinks don't
1	Bok choy, 1 cup cooked	10	8	2	Absorbable calcium, vitamin K
2	Broccoli, 100 g	9	10	5	Vitamin K, folate, sulforaphane
3	Spinach or kale, 100 g raw	10	9	3–4	Vitamin K, folate, magnesium
4	Carrots, 100 g	9	10	3	Chewed fiber
5	Tomato, 1 medium	10	10	3	Lycopene
6	Cabbage, 100 g	9	10	4–6	Vitamin K, crunch
7	Mushrooms, 100 g	9	9	4	B2, selenium
8	Banana, 1 medium	10	10	1	B6, chewable fuel
9	Guava (or berries), 100 g	10	6	5	Whole-fruit fiber
10	Papaya (or orange), 1 cup	10	7	1	Folate, gentle finish

Top picks:

- **Vegetables:** broccoli and a dark leafy green (spinach, kale or bok choy), every day if you can.
- **Fruit:** guava for fiber, banana for fuel, and papaya for an easy stomach.
- **Best value:** carrots and cabbage, at a few baht a serving.

Don't double up: vitamin C and potassium are already covered by the drinks, so you don't need to chase them here. Choose vegetables for vitamin K, folate and fiber, and fruit for chewing.



Build a Plate

The rule: 1 carb + 1 meat or fish + 1–2 vegetables. Fruit after, if you like.

- **Carb:** a fist, about 150 g cooked rice or noodles, one medium potato, or 2 slices of bread. Beans can share the carb slot: half rice, half beans.
- **Meat or fish:** a palm, about 100 g cooked (75 g for liver).
- **Vegetables:** two big handfuls, one of them green if you can.
- **A thread of fat:** a teaspoon of oil or butter to cook with, or the oil in the sardine tin. *(The plate numbers in this book don't count cooking oil or sauces.)*

A plate built this way lands at about **400–500 kcal and 30–40 g of protein** *(approx.)*, before the oil.

The weekly variety rule:

- **Fish 2+ times a week,** at least one of them oily: salmon, saba or sardines.
- **Liver once,** a small 75 g serving. Not more.
- **Red meat 1–3 times,** for iron and zinc.
- **Canned tuna** up to 2–3 cans of light tuna a week.
- **Beans 3+ times,** even if only half a portion.
- **No carb more than three days running.** Rotate through rice, potato, sweet potato, oats, noodles and bread.
- **A leafy green every day,** and a different-coloured vegetable alongside it.
- **One whole fruit a day,** one you chew, not drink.
- **Rice comes from the house rice cooker.** When you order out, pick potatoes, noodles or bread.
- **Training day vs rest day:** more of the easy carbs (white rice, potato, noodles) after a hard session; more of the fiber carbs (beans, oats, sweet potato) on a rest day.



Seven Soul Plates

In the house healthy-soul style, after Isaac Hayes: Southern comfort, lighter in the pan, with a Thai market on the side. Totals are approximate, from the item lists, and leave out cooking oil and sauces.

1. **Theme from Shaft (saba night):** air-fried saba at 200°C (390°F) for 10–12 min, white rice, garlic bok choy, tomato wedges. *About 500 kcal, 32 g protein, 4 g fiber, ~฿57.2.* The post-training plate.

2. **Soulsville Supper:** paprika-and-garlic chicken thigh, air-fried at 200°C (390°F) for 18–22 min, roasted sweet potato, greens wilted with a splash of vinegar like collards. *About 410 kcal, 33 g protein, 9 g fiber, ~฿50.0.*

3. **Do Your Thing (red beans and rice):** Instant Pot kidney beans (fully cooked) and riceberry rice, sharing the carb slot, with sliced pork loin and a quick cabbage slaw. *About 420 kcal, 38 g protein, 11 g fiber, ~฿33.9.* The rest-day plate.

4. **The Look of Love (salmon and potato):** air-fried salmon at 200°C (390°F) for 8–10 min, baked potato, broccoli, a squeeze of lemon. *About 430 kcal, 29 g protein, 8 g fiber, ~฿106.1, or ~฿52.7 with salmon belly.*

5. **Ike's Rap (beef and soba):** sirloin flashed in the wok for 2–3 min, cold soba, bok choy and mushrooms with ginger. *About 390 kcal, 42 g protein, 6 g fiber, ~฿119.9, or ~฿92.6 with white rice in place of the soba.*

6. **Never Can Say Goodbye (liver night, once a week):** liver and onions, 2–3 min a side, mashed potato, carrots and wilted spinach. *About 380 kcal, 29 g protein, 9 g fiber, ~฿45.9.*

7. **By the Time I Get to Phoenix (five-minute sardine toast):** sardines on two slices of whole-wheat sourdough, with tomato and a handful of spinach. *About 410 kcal, 36 g protein, 8 g fiber, ~฿101.4.* The no-cook plate for a busy night.

One week, three fish nights, one liver night: Shaft (Mon) · Soulsville (Tue) · Look of Love (Wed) · Do Your Thing (Thu) · Ike's Rap (Fri) · Never Can Say Goodbye (Sat) · Phoenix (Sun). Swap shrimp in for any meat when you want something lighter.

Plate names are a tribute to Isaac Hayes's songs and his cookbook *Cooking with Heart & Soul*; no affiliation.



BONUS CHAPTER · THE MORNING BOWL

The Morning Bowl

This is how the pinch hitter (page 8) gets supercharged. A bowl of plain yogurt does the milk's job, and then everything you stir in does a bit more.

Pick your base:

- **Greek yogurt:** strained and thick, roughly twice the protein of regular yogurt and a little less lactose. The post-swim base. *(Well established.)*
- **Regular plain yogurt:** lighter and looser, a bit more calcium per spoon, gentler on a tender stomach. The rest-day base.
- **Either way:** plain and unsweetened. Whole-milk or low-fat, your call. You add the sweetness, so you control it.

The house usual: Greek yogurt with whey, collagen, berry powder, sunflower seeds and the house probiotic. That's the champion of the post-swim bowls, number 23.

Two habits: stir whey and collagen in first, while the yogurt is cold and smooth, so they don't clump. Add the probiotic last and never warm the bowl, because live cultures don't like heat.



The Pick-n-Mix Bins (1)

○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

○ **BASES:** Greek yogurt · regular plain yogurt · half-and-half of each.

● **THAI FRUITS:** mango · banana · papaya · dragon fruit · guava · longan · rambutan · pineapple · passion fruit · lychee.

● **EVERYDAY FRUITS:** berries · apple · pear · kiwi · grapes · orange · peach.

● **ROASTED & COOKED:** roasted sweet potato (orange or purple), mashed while warm and chilled.

Fruit is whole, so its sugar comes with fiber. That's the good kind of sweet in this chapter. *(Well established.)*



The Pick-n-Mix Bins (2)

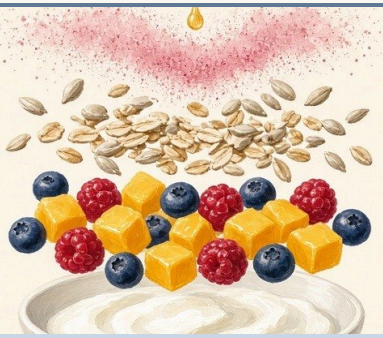
○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

CRUNCH: sunflower seeds · pumpkin seeds · chia · flax · sesame · walnuts · almonds · cashews · pecans · pistachios · oats · granola · puffed rice · toasted coconut · cacao nibs.

DRIZZLES: honey · maple · tahini · sunflower butter · date syrup.

BOOSTS: whey · collagen · berry powder · cinnamon · cardamom · ginger · five-spice · matcha (morning only) · lime zest · salt flakes · Thai chili-salt.

SAVORY: cucumber · herbs (mint, Thai basil, cilantro, dill, scallion) · chili crisp · za'atar · olive oil · a dot of miso.



How to Build a Bowl

The formula: base + one or two fruits + one crunch + one boost. Then, only if you want it, one drizzle.

○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

★ **= post-swim pick.** Greek yogurt plus whey or collagen: the high-protein builds for the hour after the pool.

The honest part on portions:

- **Drizzles add sugar fast.** One tablespoon of honey is about 17 g of sugar *(USDA typical value)*, a third of a day's free-sugar budget in a single spoon. On a five-drink day you're already over, so a drizzle should be a thread, not a pour. Maple and date syrup are much the same.
- **Granola is a sprinkle, not a base.** Many shop granolas are a quarter sugar by weight or more *(estimate; labels vary widely)*. Use a small spoonful on top, or swap it for oats or puffed rice.
- **Nuts and nut butters are dense.** A small handful is plenty.
- **Fruit is the free pass.** Whole fruit's sugar doesn't count as free sugar. Let it do the sweetening.
- **Matcha only in the morning,** for the caffeine.

None of the combos give quantities. Build it the size of your appetite and your training. *(The kitchen's judgment.)*



Thai Market (12)

○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

1. **Mango Sticky Morning:** ● mango, ● toasted coconut, ● puffed rice, ● a pinch of salt flakes.
2. **Floating Market:** ● dragon fruit, ● longan, ● lime zest, ● chia.
3. **Rambutan Rumble:** ● rambutan, ● lychee, ● toasted coconut, ● sesame.
4. **Guava Gold ★:** ○ Greek, ● whey, ● guava, ● Thai chili-salt, ● pumpkin seeds.
5. **Papaya Sunrise:** ● papaya, ● passion fruit, ● lime zest, ● flax.
6. **Night Market:** ● banana, ● sesame, ● puffed rice, ● a thread of honey.
7. **Songkran Splash:** ● pineapple, ● lychee, ● mint, ● chia.
8. **Tuk-Tuk:** ● banana, ● cashews, ● cardamom, ● a thread of date syrup.
9. **Northern Chill:** ● longan, ● ginger, ● walnuts.
10. **Som Tam Sweetheart:** ● papaya, ● lime zest, ● a pinch of chili-salt, ● cashews.
11. **Golden Triangle:** ● pineapple, ● mango, ● passion fruit, ● cashews.
12. **Monsoon:** ● dragon fruit, ● berry powder, ● chia, ● sunflower seeds.



Tropical (10)

○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

13 **Piña Colada:** ● pineapple, ● toasted coconut, ● lime zest.

14 **Passion Play:** ● passion fruit, ● banana, ● almonds.

15 **Island Time:** ● mango, ● papaya, ● toasted coconut, ● cashews.

16 **Pink Flamingo:** ● dragon fruit, ● berry powder, ● toasted coconut, ● chia.

17 **Lychee Lagoon:** ● lychee, ● lime zest, ● sesame.

18 **Sunset Strip:** ● mango, ● passion fruit, ● a sprinkle of granola.

19 **Coconut Cloud:** ● banana, ● toasted coconut, ● cinnamon, ● a thread of maple.

20 **Tiki Hut:** ● pineapple, ● ginger, ● cashews.

21 **Calypso:** ● papaya, ● banana, ● lime zest, ● pumpkin seeds.

22 **Tropic Thunder:** ● mango, ● pineapple, ● chia, ● cacao nibs.



Training Day (14)

○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

23 **The House Usual** ★: ○ Greek, ● whey, ● collagen, ● berry powder, ● sunflower seeds, ● probiotic.

24 **Lane One** ★: ○ Greek, ● whey, ● banana, ● oats, ● cinnamon.

25 **Flip Turn** ★: ○ Greek, ● collagen, ● mango, ● pumpkin seeds, ● lime zest.

26 **Butterfly Stroke** ★: ○ Greek, ● whey, ● dragon fruit, ● chia, ● almonds.

27 **Recovery Ward** ★: ○ Greek, ● whey, ● banana, ● sunflower butter, ● salt flakes.

28 **Rowing Machine** ★: ○ Greek, ● whey, ● oats, ● walnuts, ● a thread of maple.

29 **Sauna Cooler** ★: ○ Greek, ● collagen, ● pineapple, ● mint, ● chia.

30 **Heavy Lifting** ★: ○ Greek, ● whey, ● banana, ● cacao nibs, ● almonds.

31 **Second Wind** ★: ○ Greek, ● whey, ● berry powder, ● berries, ● flax.

32 **Deep End** ★: ○ Greek, ● collagen, ● guava, ● sunflower seeds, ● ginger.

33 **Medal Stand** ★: ○ Greek, ● whey, ● mango, ● toasted coconut, ● cashews.

34 **Cool Down** ★: ○ Greek, ● collagen, ● papaya, ● lime zest, ● pumpkin seeds.

35 **Matcha Morning** ★: ○ Greek, ● whey, ● matcha, ● banana, ● sesame. *(Morning only.)*

36 **Pre-Gym Light:** ○ regular yogurt, ● banana, ● oats. *An easy one an hour before a row.*



Rest Day (10)

○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

37 **Lazy Sunday:** ○ regular yogurt, ● berries, ● walnuts, ● cinnamon.

38 **Slow Lane:** ○ Greek, ● kiwi, ● flax, ● lime zest.

39 **Hammock:** ○ regular yogurt, ● papaya, ● chia.

40 **Quiet Hours:** ○ Greek, ● apple, ● cinnamon, ● almonds.

41 **Rain Check:** ○ regular yogurt, ● pear, ● ginger, ● walnuts.

42 **Low Tide:** ○ Greek, ● guava, ● pumpkin seeds.

43 **Couch Day:** ○ regular yogurt, ● orange, ● cardamom, ● pistachios.

44 **Gentle Gut:** ○ regular yogurt, ● papaya, ● ginger.

45 **Green Room:** ○ Greek, ● kiwi, ● cucumber, ● mint.

46 **Just Enough:** ○ Greek, ● berries, ● sunflower seeds. *Nothing else.*



Dessert for Breakfast (12)

○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

47 **Black Forest:** ○ Greek, ● berries, ● cacao nibs, ● a thread of maple.

48 **Banoffee:** ● banana, ● walnuts, ● salt flakes, ● a thread of date syrup.

49 **Cheesecake Morning:** ○ Greek, ● berries, ● lime zest, ● a sprinkle of granola.

50 **Tiramisu-ish:** ○ Greek, ● cacao nibs, ● cinnamon, ● a splash of cold coffee. *(Morning only.)*

51 **Apple Pie:** ● apple, ● cinnamon, ● oats, ● walnuts.

52 **Mango Mousse:** ○ Greek whipped smooth, ● mango, ● lime zest, ● toasted coconut.

53 **Banana Split:** ● banana, ● berries, ● cacao nibs, ● almonds.

54 **Baklava:** ● walnuts, ● pistachios, ● cinnamon, ● a thread of honey.

55 **Brownie Batter ★:** ○ Greek, ● whey, ● cacao nibs, ● a thread of date syrup.

56 **Key Lime:** ● lime zest, ● a sprinkle of granola, ● a thread of honey.

57 **Halva:** ● tahini, ● sesame, ● cardamom.

58 **Rice Pudding:** ● puffed rice, ● cinnamon, ● cardamom, ● a thread of date syrup.



Soul Nods (8) & Kitchen Library (6)

○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

Soul Nods, after Isaac Hayes's healthier Southern cooking:

59 **Sweet Potato Pie Bowl:** ● roasted sweet potato, ● cinnamon, ● pecans, ● a thread of maple.

60 **Banana Pudding Bowl:** ● banana, ● cinnamon, ● a sprinkle of granola for the wafer crunch.

61 **Peach Cobbler Bowl:** ● peach, ● oats, ● cinnamon.

62 **Hot Buttered Soul:** ● banana, ● toasted pecans, ● cinnamon, ● salt flakes.

63 **Black Moses:** ● banana, ● cacao nibs, ● walnuts, ● a thread of date syrup.

64 **Walk On By:** ● berries, ● almonds. *Simple as a stroll.*

65 **Can You Dig It ★:** ○ Greek, ● whey, ● roasted sweet potato, ● pecans, ● cinnamon.

66 **Breakfast of Champions:** ● mixed fruit, ● walnuts, ● oats. *His morning grains and fruit, by way of a bowl.*

Kitchen Library tie-ins:

67 **The Golden Sweet Potato:** ● roasted sweet potato, ● ginger, ● sesame, ● a thread of honey.

68 **Purple Reign:** ● purple sweet potato, ● toasted coconut, ● cardamom.

69 **Rolled & Ready:** ● cucumber, ● mint, ● Thai basil, ● lime zest, ● sesame, ● a dot of chili crisp.

70 **The Big Dipper:** ○ Greek, ● herbs, ● cucumber, ● olive oil, ● salt flakes. *Scoop it with plain chips.*

71 **The Way Back to the Table:** ○ regular yogurt, ● banana, ● oats, ● ginger. *For a tender stomach.*

72 **5 Alive:** ● mango, ● grapes, ● chia, ● lime zest.



Spice Route (10)

BASE · FRUIT · CRUNCH · BOOST · DRIZZLE · SAVORY

73 **Chai:** cinnamon, cardamom, ginger, almonds.

74 **Masala Mango:** mango, cardamom, pistachios.

75 **Persian Garden:** berries, pistachios, cardamom.

76 **Marrakech:** orange, cinnamon, almonds, a thread of date syrup.

77 **Spiced Pear:** pear, ginger, walnuts.

78 **Gingerbread:** ginger, cinnamon, oats, a thread of date syrup.

79 **Cardamom Cacao:** cacao nibs, cardamom, cinnamon, banana.

80 **Five-Spice Apple:** apple, a pinch of five-spice, walnuts.

81 **Levant:** tahini, sesame, cinnamon, a thread of date syrup.

82 **Kashmir:** apple, almonds, cardamom.



Savory (10)

○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

83 **Tzatziki Bowl:** ● cucumber, ● dill, ● olive oil, ● salt flakes.

84 **Za'atar Sunrise:** ● za'atar, ● olive oil, ● cucumber.

85 **Chili Crisp Cooler:** ● cucumber, ● chili crisp, ● sesame.

86 **Herb Garden:** ● Thai basil, ● mint, ● cilantro, ● lime zest, ● olive oil.

87 **Labneh-Style:** ○ Greek, ● olive oil, ● za'atar, ● pumpkin seeds.

88 **Greek Salad Bowl:** ● cucumber, ● herbs, ● olive oil, ● sunflower seeds, ● salt flakes.

89 **Raita:** ● cucumber, ● mint, ● ginger.

90 **Everything Bowl:** ● sesame, ● flax, ● salt flakes, ● olive oil.

91 **Sichuan Morning:** ● chili crisp, ● sesame, ● cucumber, ● scallion.

92 **Green Goddess ★:** ○ Greek, ● collagen, ● herbs, ● cucumber, ● olive oil.



Salty-Sweet (8)

○ BASE ● FRUIT ● CRUNCH ● BOOST ● DRIZZLE ● SAVORY

93 **Salted Caramel:** ● cashews, ● salt flakes, ● a thread of date syrup.

94 **Honey Sesame Crunch:** ● sesame, ● puffed rice, ● salt flakes, ● a thread of honey.

95 **Kettle Corn:** ● puffed rice, ● cinnamon, ● salt flakes, ● a thread of maple.

96 **Salted Maple Pecan:** ● pecans, ● salt flakes, ● a thread of maple.

97 **Miso Honey:** ● a dot of miso whisked into a thread of honey, ● sesame.

98 **Chili Mango:** ● mango, ● Thai chili-salt, ● lime zest. *The street-fruit classic.*

99 **Seed Brittle:** ● sunflower and pumpkin seeds toasted with salt, ● a thread of honey.

100 **The Big Finish:** ● banana, ● berries, ● granola, ● sunflower butter, ● cacao nibs, ● salt flakes. *The over-the-top one. Once in a while, baby.*

> **Can't choose?** Roll two dice for the tens and ones, and eat what comes up.



ROAD KIT · TRAVEL LIGHT, EAT SMART

The Road Kit

Some trips don't come with a kitchen. Hotel rooms, long-haul flights, a week of meetings, a competition weekend far from home. You can't carry five drinks and a small plate in a carry-on, baby. But you can carry a small bag of powders and pills that keeps the floor from falling out.

The rule of the road: buy real food first, wherever you land. A carton of milk, a yogurt cup, a coconut, a banana: every 7-Eleven, airport kiosk and corner shop in the world has something. The kit fills the gaps the shop can't.

What the kit covers:

- **Protein:** plain whey, so a carton of milk becomes a proper meal.
- **Fluids and salts:** an electrolyte sachet for flights, heat and hard sessions.
- **Fiber:** psyllium, because travel slows the gut down.
- **The quiet stuff:** a multivitamin, omega-3, vitamin D and magnesium, for the days with no fish, no sun and no greens.

How to read the next pages: each item has what it covers, a typical label dose, how to pack and mix it, an evidence grade, and a "skip if" line. The grades:

- **Strong:** good human evidence it does the job.
- **Moderate:** decent evidence, with open questions.
- **Weak / insurance only:** cheap cover for a gap, not a fix.

Doses are general guidance from typical labels, not a prescription. Follow your own pack, and check with a doctor or pharmacist if you take any medicine.



The Powders (1)

1 Plain whey protein (concentrate or isolate) · STRONG

- **Covers:** complete protein with all the essential amino acids, high in leucine, the one that switches on muscle repair. One scoop turns a carton of milk into a real post-training meal.
- **Typical dose:** one scoop, 20–30 g of powder, giving about 20–25 g of protein. One or two a day on the road.
- **Pack and mix:** pre-portion scoops into small bags or a stacking powder funnel. Shake it into cold milk, coconut water or water in a shaker bottle; never into boiling liquid, because it clumps. Isolate mixes thinner and has less lactose, if milk sugar bothers you.
- **Pick:** plain or lightly flavoured whey, with no added "proprietary blends". Keep it a whey-only product, not a plant blend.
- **Skip if:** a doctor has told you to limit protein (for example kidney disease), or you have a true milk allergy.

2 Collagen peptides · WEAK TO MODERATE

- **Covers:** extra protein that dissolves clear in hot or cold drinks, even coffee. Some studies show small benefits for skin and joints, but the evidence is modest.
- **The catch:** collagen is **not a complete protein**. It is missing tryptophan, so it doesn't count like whey for muscle repair. Use it as a top-up, never as the main protein.
- **Typical dose:** 10–15 g a day.
- **Pack and mix:** one sachet or one scoop per day. Stir it into the morning coffee (before lunch) or a cup of hot water with lemon.
- **Skip if:** you're short on space. It's the first thing to leave behind.

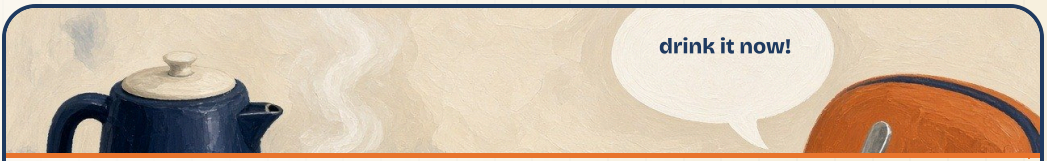
3 Greens powder · WEAK / INSURANCE ONLY

- **Covers:** small amounts of vitamins, plant compounds and a little fiber from dried vegetables, grasses and fruit.
- **The honest bit:** a scoop is a backup, not a salad. Doses of each ingredient are usually small, and the proof that it works like real vegetables isn't there.
- **Typical dose:** one scoop, per the label.
- **Pack and mix:** single-serve sachets travel best. Shake into cold water or coconut water.
- **Skip if:** you take warfarin or other blood thinners (vitamin K varies), or the label hides its doses behind a "blend". It's optional, and the priciest thing in the kit.

The Powders (1) *(continued)*

4 Electrolytes / oral rehydration salts · STRONG (for real fluid loss)

- **Covers:** sodium, potassium and glucose in the right balance to pull water into the body after sweating, heat, long flights or a stomach bug. Oral rehydration salts are the World Health Organization standard for diarrhoea.
- **Thai example:** Royal-D electrolyte drink, sold by the sachet at every pharmacy and 7-Eleven. It carries sugar, so save it for the days you actually lose fluid, not as a daily habit.
- **Typical dose:** one sachet mixed in the water volume on the pack, usually 250 ml. Getting the water amount right matters: too strong a mix works less well.
- **Pack and mix:** flat sachets weigh nothing. A sports bottle and the hotel tap or bottled water is all you need.
- **At home, too:** on a hot or sweaty training day (a swim or a row), grape Royal-D can take the mango-grape drink's place (page 6). There, its salts are a plus, not a minus. Don't stack the two: one sweet drink a day. Keep the mango-grape for rest days.
- **Skip if:** you're on a salt-restricted diet, or have kidney or heart problems, without asking a doctor first.



The Powders (2)

5 Psyllium husk (or inulin) · ◐

STRONG for regularity (psyllium); MODERATE for inulin

- **Covers:** soluble fiber, the thing drinks and hotel breakfasts are short of. Psyllium has good evidence for keeping you regular and a modest effect on cholesterol. Inulin is a prebiotic fiber that feeds gut bacteria, but it is gassier.
- **Typical dose: start small**: 1 teaspoon (about 3–5 g) once a day, building up over a week to 1 tablespoon if you need it.
- **Pack and mix:** stir into a **full glass of water**, at least 250 ml, and drink it straight away before it sets into a gel. Then drink another glass of water. Plenty of fluid is not optional with psyllium.
- **Skip if:** you have trouble swallowing, or a history of bowel blockage. Take it at least 2 hours away from medicines and other pills, because it can slow how they're absorbed.

6 Instant oats · STRONG (it's just food)

- **Covers:** slow carbs, beta-glucan fiber, and a real breakfast when there's only a kettle.
- **Typical portion:** 40 g, about half a cup.
- **Pack and mix:** pre-portion into zip bags with a spoon of powdered milk and a teaspoon of chia. Add hot water from the kettle, stir, wait 3 minutes. Recipe on page 60.

7 Powdered milk · STRONG (it's milk, just dry)

- **Covers:** the same calcium, protein and B12 as drink #4, for places where a cold carton is hard to find.
- **Typical portion:** about 30 g of powder, mixed into 200–250 ml of water, makes one glass.
- **Pack and mix:** a small tin or a few stick packs. Mix with cold water and shake well; whole-milk powder tastes closest to the real thing.
- **Skip if:** you can buy fresh milk where you are. Fresh is better, and you save the space.

8 Chia seeds · MODERATE

- **Covers:** fiber (about 3–4 g a tablespoon), some plant omega-3 (ALA) and a little protein. Note: plant omega-3 is not the same as the fish kind; your body converts only a small amount.
- **Typical portion:** 1 tablespoon, about 10 g.
- **Pack and mix:** stir into a yogurt cup, oats or a shake. Let it sit 5 minutes to soften. Drink extra water alongside, as with psyllium.
- **Skip if:** you're already taking psyllium and your gut is complaining. Pick one fiber, not two, for the first few days.



The Pills

9 Multivitamin and mineral

WEAK / INSURANCE ONLY

- **Covers:** small daily amounts of the vitamins and minerals a thin travel diet may miss. Big studies in healthy adults show little effect on disease, but it fills gaps cheaply.
- **Typical dose:** one tablet a day with food, a standard "one-a-day", **no megadoses** (nothing far above 100% of the daily value except vitamin D).
- **Pick:** one **without iron**, unless a blood test has shown you're low. Most men don't need extra iron, and too much builds up.
- **Skip if:** you're already taking separate high doses of the same vitamins. Doubling up is how people overshoot vitamin A, zinc or iron.

10 Omega-3: fish oil, or algae oil

MODERATE

- **Covers:** EPA and DHA, the fats you'd normally get from oily fish twice a week. On a trip with no salmon or mackerel, this is the stand-in. The evidence for heart benefits in healthy people is mixed; the evidence that it delivers the fats is solid.
- **Typical dose:** enough capsules to give about 250–500 mg of EPA + DHA a day. Read the back of the label, not the "1,000 mg" on the front: a standard 1,000 mg capsule usually holds about 300 mg of omega-3.
- **Algae oil:** the fish-free version, with the same DHA (and often EPA). It costs more.
- **Pack and mix:** take with a meal to avoid fishy burps. Keep them out of the hot sun.
- **Skip if:** you take blood thinners, or have surgery coming up, without checking with a doctor.

The Pills *(continued)*

11 Vitamin D3 · STRONG for fixing a low level; MODERATE otherwise

- **Covers:** bones, muscles and immunity. Most of your vitamin D comes from sun on the skin, and indoor hotel weeks or winter trips cut that off.
- **Typical dose:** 1,000–2,000 IU (25–50 µg) a day, with a meal that has some fat. **Stay at or under 4,000 IU a day** unless a doctor has prescribed more.
- **Pack and mix:** tiny softgels; a week's worth fits in the corner of a pill box.
- **Skip if:** you already take a multivitamin with plenty of D, or have kidney stones or high calcium.

12 Magnesium (glycinate or citrate) · WEAK TO MODERATE

- **Covers:** a mineral most adults eat too little of. Some people find it helps sleep and cramps, but the evidence for both is modest.
- **Typical dose:** 100–350 mg of elemental magnesium a day, often in the evening. 350 mg is the adult upper limit from supplements.
- **Which one: glycinate** is gentle on the gut. **Citrate loosens stools**, which is either a side effect or the whole point, depending on how the travel gut is going.
- **Skip if:** you have kidney disease, or take certain antibiotics or osteoporosis medicines (take them at least 2 hours apart).

13 Probiotic capsules · WEAK TO MODERATE

- **Covers:** some strains may modestly lower the risk of traveller's diarrhoea and antibiotic-related upset. Results vary a lot by strain.
- **Typical dose:** one capsule a day, per the label. Start a few days before you fly.
- **Pack and mix:** choose a shelf-stable one if you won't have a fridge. Check the label: many need cool storage.
- **Skip if:** you're seriously ill or have a weakened immune system. Ask a doctor first.

Three short notes:

- **B12:** milk, yogurt and whey already cover it. You only need a separate B12 if you stop eating animal foods, or a blood test says you're low.
- **Iron:** only if tested low. Not "just in case".
- **No caffeine pills.** The road kit follows the house rule: coffee before lunch, none after. Jet lag is tempting, but sleep on the new clock fixes it faster than a pill.



Two-Minute Travel Shakes

Shaker bottle, one scoop, whatever the shop has. Every one of these is ready in two minutes.

1. **The Hotel Room** *(post-training)*

   250 ml carton of milk + 1 scoop whey + 1 banana. Shake the milk and whey, eat the banana alongside (or mash it in if you've got a fork and patience).

   About 360 kcal, 29 g protein *(estimate: milk typical, whey from a typical label)*.

2. **The Hot-Day Refill** *(heat, sweat, long flights)*

   330 ml coconut water + 1 scoop whey + ½ electrolyte sachet (or a good pinch of salt).

   About 170 kcal, 20 g protein, roughly 900 mg potassium *(estimate: coconut water scaled from the Chabaa label; other brands vary)*. Add the sugar from the sachet if you use one.

3. **The Cup Bowl** *(breakfast)*

   A 150 g Greek yogurt cup + ½ scoop whey + 1 tablespoon chia + any fruit the shop sells: banana, mango, a few berries. Stir, wait 5 minutes for the chia.

   About 300 kcal, 25 g protein **(estimate)**. It's a pocket version of The Morning Bowl (page 41).

4. **The No-Fridge Jar** *(when there's only a kettle)*

   40 g instant oats + 30 g powdered milk + 1 teaspoon chia in a mug. Add 200 ml hot water, stir, wait 3 minutes. Let it cool a little, then stir in 1 scoop whey. (Whey clumps in boiling water, so it goes in last.)

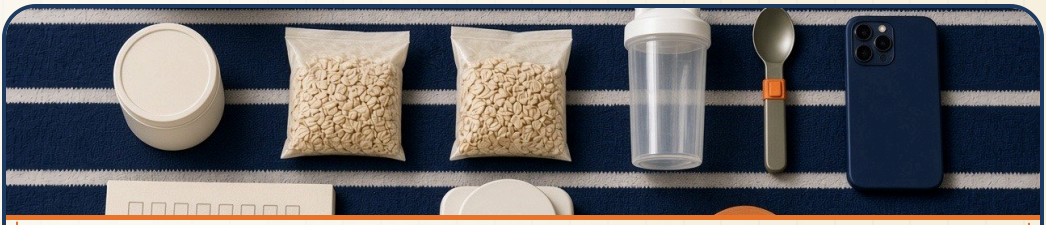
   About 420 kcal, 34 g protein **(estimate)**.

5. **The Clear One** *(morning, before lunch)*

   Coffee from the hotel lobby + 1 scoop of collagen. It dissolves invisibly. Remember: collagen is a top-up, not your main protein for the day.

   About 40 kcal, 10 g protein **(estimate)**.

Shake rules: cold liquid first, powder second, lid on tight. Rinse the bottle straight away, or the hotel room will remind you tomorrow.



The One-Week Kit

One small zip bag, seven days. Weigh it out at home, label everything, done.

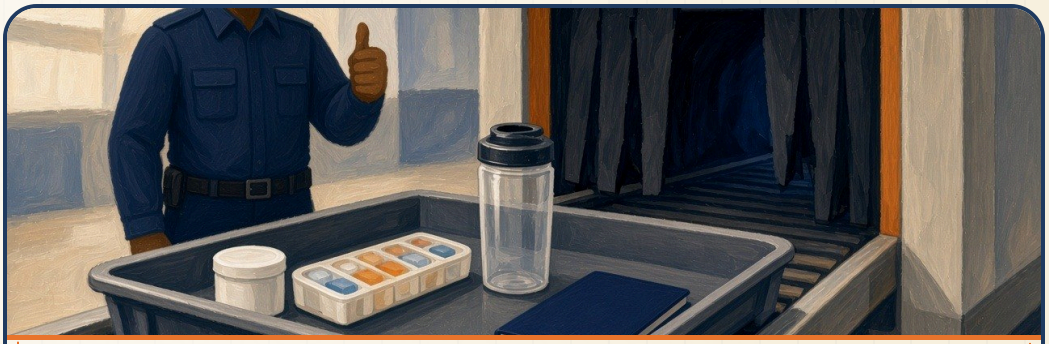
The checklist:

- ☐ Whey protein: 7 scoops (175 g) in portioned bags, plus the scoop
- ☐ Collagen: 7 sachets or 105 g
- ☐ Electrolyte sachets: 7 (one a day on hot or travel days)
- ☐ Psyllium: 35 g, about 7 teaspoons
- ☐ Chia: 70 g
- ☐ Instant oats: 7 × 40 g bags
- ☐ Pill box: 7 multivitamins, 14 fish-oil capsules, 7 vitamin D3, 14 magnesium tablets
- ☐ Optional: probiotics, greens sachets, powdered milk stick packs
- ☐ Shaker bottle, a folding spoon, a few spare zip bags
- ☐ Photos of every label on your phone

What it costs in Thailand *(per day / per week)*:

Item	Per day	Per week	Price basis
Whey, 25 g scoop	฿23.9	฿167.1	● house pantry price
Collagen, 15 g	฿11.3	฿79.3	● house pantry price
Royal-D electrolyte, 1 sachet	฿6.5	฿45.6	● house pantry price
Psyllium, 5 g	฿8.2	฿57.7	฿299 per 181 g at a Thai pharmacy chain, Oct 2026
Multivitamin, 1 tablet	฿9.0	฿62.8	฿269 per 30 at a Thai pharmacy chain, Oct 2026
Fish oil, 2 capsules	฿5.4	฿37.7	฿323.56 per 120 from an online store, Oct 2026
Vitamin D3, 1 softgel	*~฿2.0*	*~฿14.0*	estimate
Magnesium glycinate, 2 tablets	฿8.6	฿60.5	฿777.95 per 180 from an online store, Oct 2026
Chia, 10 g	*~฿3.0*	*~฿21.0*	estimate
Instant oats, 40 g	*~฿6.4*	*~฿44.8*	estimate
Core kit	**~฿84.4**	**~฿590.5**	
Probiotic, 1 capsule *(optional)*	฿13.3	฿93.4	฿800.51 per 60 from an online store, Oct 2026
Greens powder (optional)	*~฿30.0*	*~฿210.0*	estimate
Powdered milk, 30 g (optional)	*~฿15.0*	*~฿105.0*	estimate
Everything	**~฿142.7**	**~฿998.9**	

Read it straight: the core kit costs about two-thirds of a home five-drink day (฿124.0, page 18), and less than one ฿139.0 steak-house delivery. Whey is over a quarter of the bill and does most of the work. The greens are the first thing to cut.



Through Security, and Safely

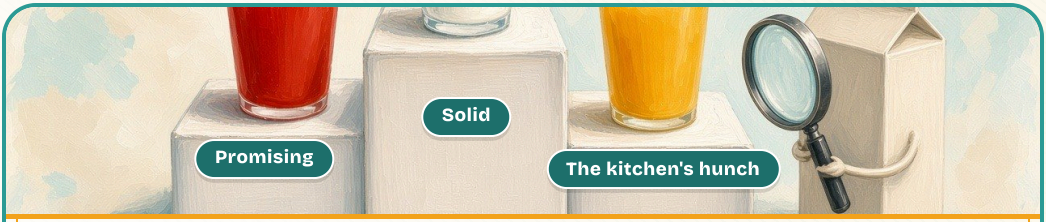
AT THE AIRPORT:

- **Powders over about 350 ml (12 oz)** in your carry-on may be pulled aside for extra screening in the US and some other countries. Put the big tub in your checked bag and carry only a day or two of pre-portioned bags.
- **Pills and powders stay in their original, labelled containers** where you can, or carry a photo of the label. An unlabelled bag of white powder is the fastest way to a long conversation.
- **Know the destination.** A few countries restrict some supplements that are ordinary in Thailand (melatonin and some herbal products are common examples). Check the embassy or customs website before you pack anything unusual.
- **Liquids:** a protein shake already mixed counts as a liquid, so it follows the 100 ml rule. Pack powder dry and mix it after security.

STAYING SAFE:

- **More is not better.** Typical label doses only. No megadoses, and don't stack products with the same vitamins.
- **Iron only if tested low.** Vitamin D up to 4,000 IU a day unless prescribed. Magnesium up to 350 mg from supplements.
- **Medicines first.** Fish oil, greens and vitamin K, psyllium, magnesium and probiotics can all interact with common medicines. If you take anything regularly, show the kit to a pharmacist.
- **Buy from a real shop.** Official stores and pharmacy chains; skip unbranded powders with "proprietary blends".
- **The kit is for the road.** When you're back in the house kitchen, real food and the five drinks take over again.

Not medical advice. This is a kitchen guide, not a prescription. Check with a doctor or pharmacist before you start a supplement, especially if you have a health condition, are on medicines, or have surgery coming up.



SECTION 5 · KEEPING IT HONEST

How Sure Are We?

Straight off the label: every figure for the Malee Red and Green and the Chabaa grape-mango and coconut water: calories, sugars, potassium, vitamins A and C. Milk and yogurt figures are typical values, not labels. The Other Half's food figures are approximate typical values (USDA), not labels, and real foods vary. The Royal-D figures come from the house log until the label is checked.

Well established:

- Oily fish twice a week is the simplest reliable source of omega-3 fats.
- Most adults eat too little potassium, fiber, calcium and magnesium.
- Fruit juice sugar counts as free sugar, and too much of it isn't good for you, even when it's "natural." Five drinks is 62 g; the guideline is under about 50 g.
- Milk and yogurt are strong sources of calcium, B12 and protein, and Greek yogurt has roughly twice the protein of regular yogurt.
- Coconut water is rich in potassium and low in sodium.
- Caffeine late in the day disturbs sleep.
- **The Other Half:** oily fish is the main food source of EPA and DHA; red meat and liver supply well-absorbed iron, zinc and B12; liver's vitamin A is high enough that once a week is the sensible limit; beans, oats and whole vegetables bring fiber that drinks don't.
- **Road Kit:** whey is a complete, high-quality protein; oral rehydration salts restore fluid and salts after real losses; psyllium helps regularity; vitamin D3 corrects a low level; oats, powdered milk and chia are just food.

Reasonably well established, with open questions:

- Added-back fiber helps the gut, but whole foods do more. How much more is still being studied.
- Liquid calories fill you up less than solid food does.
- Coconut water rehydrates about as well as water, but it isn't a full sports drink.
- Organic milk differs only slightly from regular milk in nutrients.
- **Road Kit:** fish or algae oil reliably delivers EPA and DHA, but heart benefits in healthy people are mixed. Collagen is useful protein but incomplete, with modest skin and joint evidence. Magnesium for sleep and cramps, and probiotics for traveller's diarrhoea, show modest, strain-dependent or mixed results. Inulin feeds gut bacteria but causes gas.
- **Road Kit, insurance only:** a multivitamin in healthy adults, and greens powder. Cheap cover for a thin week, not a fix.

How Sure Are We? *(continued)*

The kitchen's practical judgment, not proven:

- That five drinks plus the small plate gets you "close to complete." It's built from the labels and typical values, not from a study of this exact diet.
- The rest-day trim, the drink timings and the 100 bowl combos.
- The Road Kit line-up and the travel shakes: built from typical labels and general guidance, not tested as a set.
- The Other Half scores (nutrition, cost, ease, travel, digestion), the build-a-plate rule, the weekly variety rule and the seven soul plates. The digestion scores are a general guide; your own gut has the final say.
- The Royal-D hot-day swap: sensible when you sweat, but not tested against the juice.
- That habits you can repeat beat perfect plans you can't.

Not medical advice. This is a kitchen guide. If you have diabetes, kidney disease or a heart condition, or take medicines affected by potassium, talk to a doctor before adding this much juice or coconut water.

The Five-a-Day Cheat Card

TRAINING DAY: all five *(~525 kcal, 62 g fruit sugar + ~10 g lactose, ฿124.0)*

1. **Milk or a yogurt bowl** after the swim, at breakfast (★ combos, pages 41–53).
2. **Red** mid-morning.
3. **Grape-mango** after the hard session. *(Hot, sweaty day? Grape Royal-D instead. Never both.)*
4. **Coconut water** after the sauna, with something salty.
5. **Green** with an early dinner.

REST DAY: three *(~305 kcal, 23 g fruit sugar + ~10 g lactose, ฿65.0)*

Milk or a yogurt bowl · coconut water · one juice. Drop the grape-mango first.

THE SMALL PLATE, a few times a week:

Oily fish ×2 · chicken or pork · eggs, hidden · rice, potatoes or oats · leafy greens · navy, black or kidney beans, or edamame · seeds · yogurt · one whole fruit.

BUILD A PLATE: 1 carb (a fist) + 1 meat or fish (a palm) + 1–2 vegetables (two handfuls). Fish 2+ times a week, liver once, beans 3+ times, a green every day (page 39).

THE MORNING BOWL: base + one or two fruits + one crunch + one boost. One drizzle, a thread.

ON THE ROAD: buy real food first. Then whey in milk, an electrolyte on hot or flight days, psyllium with a full glass of water, and one pill box (multi, fish oil, D3, magnesium). Typical label doses only (pages 58–59).

THREE RULES:

Drinks sit beside meals, never instead of them. · No caffeine after lunch. · Light dinner, early.

Cut along the line and stick it on the fridge. Now go pour one, baby.

Sources

- Malee Power Plants Red and Green: nutrition per 330 ml from the product labels; prices from a house receipt, Oct 2026.
- Chabaa 100% Mango with Grape Juice and Chabaa Coco 100% Coconut Water: nutrition per 200 ml serving and ingredients from the product labels (Thai RDI, 2,000 kcal); 1 L prices from a house receipt, Oct 2026.
- Drink prices: Malee ฿38.8 per box, Chabaa grape-mango ฿101.2 per 1 L and coconut water ฿83.3 per 1 L (online orders with shipping spread across the boxes), organic whole milk ฿95.0 per 2 L and Union Farmers Greek yogurt ฿399.0 per 2 kg tub: house receipts, Oct 2026.
- Coffee: robot-barista double-shot Americano, ฿50.0, house receipt, Oct 2026. The flat white price and nutrition are estimates: a typical Thai café price, and USDA typical values for whole milk. Meal reference prices: house receipts and the house food log, Oct 2026, where marked; everything else marked **(estimate)** is a typical Thai price, not a checked listing.
- Milk and yogurt nutrients: typical values from USDA FoodData Central for whole milk, plain whole-milk yogurt and plain whole-milk Greek yogurt. Honey sugar: USDA FoodData Central.
- Organic vs conventional milk: systematic reviews of milk composition (e.g. Średnicka-Tober et al., *British Journal of Nutrition*, 2016) and UK studies of milk iodine.
- Free sugars: World Health Organization guideline on sugars intake for adults and children (2015), which counts fruit juice sugars as free sugars and recommends under 10% of energy.
- Omega-3 and fish twice a week: American Heart Association and national dietary guidelines.
- Commonly under-consumed nutrients (potassium, fiber, calcium, vitamin D, magnesium): Dietary Guidelines for Americans 2020–2025.
- The Old Ways, with Plutarch: primary sources as cited in each vignette (Plutarch's *Life of Lycurgus*, Diogenes Laertius, Musonius Rufus, Seneca, the Book of Daniel, Josephus, the *Rule of St Benedict*, the Mawangdui manuscripts, Cornaro, William of Rubruck, Marco Polo, James Lind's *Treatise of the Scurvy*).
- Road Kit prices: whey, collagen and Royal-D from the house pantry list, Oct 2026; psyllium (฿299 per 181.44 g) and multivitamin (฿269 per 30 tablets) from a Thai pharmacy chain's online store; fish oil (฿323.56 per 120 softgels), magnesium glycinate (฿777.95 per 180 tablets) and probiotic (฿800.51 per 60 capsules) from an online supplement store's Thai site, all checked Oct 2026. Vitamin D3, chia, oats, greens powder and powdered milk are marked **(estimate)**.
- Road Kit doses and upper limits: typical product labels; US National Institutes of Health Office of Dietary Supplements fact sheets (vitamin D upper limit 4,000 IU; supplemental magnesium upper limit 350 mg); WHO oral rehydration salts guidance. Airport powder screening: US TSA guidance on powders over 12 oz (350 ml) in carry-on.
- The Other Half: nutrition per serving from USDA FoodData Central typical values, rounded and marked approximate. Prices from house receipts and the house price list (Thai suppliers, 2025–2026) where marked; white rice, oats, bread, rice noodles, soba, fresh corn, saba, canned tuna, raw pork loin, liver, shrimp, bok choy, tomato, cabbage, spinach, guava and market papaya are **(estimate)**.
- Royal-D: ฿6.51 a sachet from the house pantry list; kcal, sugar and sodium from the house food log, with the label check pending.
- Bowl combos and everything else: the kitchen's practical judgment, marked as such in the text.